

West Visayas State University
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY
La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

Enhancing Civil Society Organization (CSO) Accreditation and
Performance Evaluation Process through Document Management: A
Web-Based System for the Department of Agriculture Region 6

An Undergraduate Thesis
Presented to the Faculty of the
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In Partial Fulfillment
of the Requirements for the Degretives
Bachelor of Science in Information Systems

by
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Approval Sheet

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Abstract

This research seeks to develop a web-based system to improve the efficiency and transparency between the Department of Agriculture (DA) and Civil Society Organizations (CSOs). The proposed system will centralize and program core functions, including account registration, accreditation procedures, document validation, project monitoring, and performance evaluation and ranking.

Through an intuitive user interface and a robust database, the system minimizes administrative burdens, reduces paperwork, and shortens processing times. It enables real-time communication between the DA and CSOs, fostering prompt analysis and responsive decision-making. Additionally, the system includes a performance evaluation tool to assess CSOs' financial stability and project outcomes, empowering the DA to

make well-informed decisions regarding project support and budget allocations. A weighted scoring method ranks CSOs based on multiple performance indicators, ensuring a fair and objective evaluation process.

The implementation of this system is anticipated to significantly improve the efficiency and effectiveness of DA-CSO partnerships, promoting greater accountability, transparency, and overall performance in agricultural development initiatives.

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Table of Contents

Approval Sheet	2
Acknowledgment	3
Abstract	5
Table of Contents	7
List of Figures	10
List of Tables	12
List of Appendices	13
CHAPTER 1 INTRODUCTION TO THE STUDY	1
Background of the Study and Conceptual Framework	1
Objectives of the Study	14
Significance of the Study	15
Delimitation of the Study	17
Definition of Terms	19
CHAPTER 2 REVIEW OF RELATED STUDIES	24
Review of Existing and Related Studies	24
Current Systems	24
Related Systems or Solutions	26
Related Studies	29
CHAPTER 3 RESEARCH DESIGN AND METHODOLOGY	33
Description of the Proposed Study	33

West Visayas State University
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY
La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

Methods and Proposed Enhancements	34
Components and Design	37
Software Architecture	37
System Architecture	38
Database Design	40
Procedural Design	41
Object-Oriented Designs	43
Process Design	48
Methodology	50
System Development Life Cycle	50
CHAPTER 4 RESULTS AND DISCUSSION	52
Implementation	52
Development Tools	52
Hardware Requirements	53
Software Requirements	54
Input and Outputs of the Study	54
Results Interpretation and Analysis	77
System Evaluation Results	79
CHAPTER 5 SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS	81
Summary of the Proposed Study Design and Implementation	81
Summary of Findings	84

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COLLEGE OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY
La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

Conclusions	86
Recommendations	88
References	90
Appendices	100

List of Figures

Figure 1. Conceptual Framework of the Proposed System	13
Figure 2. Software Architectural Design of the Proposed System	37
Figure 3. System Architectural Design of the Proposed System	39
Figure 4. Database Design of the Proposed System	41
Figure 5. Procedural Design of the Proposed System	44
Figure 6. Use Case Design of the Proposed System	46
Figure 7. Activity Design of the Proposed System	48
Figure 8. Data Flow Diagram of the Proposed System	49
Figure 9. Process Design of the Proposed System	50
Figure 10. Methodology for the Proposed System	51
Figure 11. Landing Page(1)	56
Figure 12. Landing Page(2)	57
Figure 13. Login Page	58
Figure 14. Registration of CSO Representative	59
Figure 15. Registration of CSO Office	60
Figure 16. Admin Account Controls	61
Figure 17. Email Verification	62
Figure 18. Successful Email Verification	63
Figure 19. CSO Representative Dashboard	64
Figure 20. CSO Representative Profile Tab	65

West Visayas State University
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY
La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

Figure 21. Applying for Accreditation	66
Figure 22. Uploading of Documentary Requirement	66
Figure 23. Accreditation Status	67
Figure 24. Admin Verification of Documents	68
Figure 25. Admin Status Updation	69
Figure 26. List of Accredited Users	70
Figure 27. List of Denied Applications for Accreditations	71
Figure 28. Submission of Accomplishment Report	72
Figure 29. CSO Endorsing Proposals	73
Figure 30. Project for CSO	74
Figure 31. Announcements	75
Figure 32. Renewal of Application	76
Figure 33. CSO Dashboard	77
Figure 34. Admin Dashboard	77
Figure 35. Announcements by Admin	78
Figure 36. Admin Dashboard (2)	79
Figure 37. CSO Archive Documents	80

List of Tables

Table 1. Evaluation Results of the Proposed System	84
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West Visayas State University
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS TECHNOLOGY
La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

List of Appendices

Appendix A List of Documentary Requirements	101
Appendix B Letter to Evaluators	102
Appendix C System Evaluation Form	105

CHAPTER 1 INTRODUCTION TO THE STUDY

Background of the Study and Conceptual Framework

The Philippines has established constitutional provisions to promote the prosperity of its citizens and economy. Article 2, Section 23 of the 1987 Philippine Constitution states, "The State shall encourage non-governmental, community-based, or sectoral organizations that promote the nation's welfare [1]." To achieve this, agencies have begun accrediting eligible Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), allowing them to receive public funds if they meet the conditions under Section 73 of the General Provisions of the 2022 General Appropriations Act (GAA) [2].

CSOs encompass various entities such as civic organizations, non-government organizations (NGOs), people's organizations (POs), cooperatives, trade unions, professional associations, media groups, indigenous peoples' organizations (IPOs), and non-profit organizations (NPOs) or foundations. These organizations represent their members' or others' interests and values, considering socio-economic, ethical, cultural, and specific factors. Furthermore, they are officially registered with authorities like the

Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), Cooperative Development Authority (CDA), Department of Labor and Employment–Bureau of Rural Workers (DOLE-BRW), or the National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP) [3].

One of the country's agencies, the Department of Agriculture (DA), promotes agricultural development by providing the policy framework, public investments, and support services necessary for domestic and export-oriented business enterprises [4]. Aligned with the goals outlined in the Philippine Development Plan (PDP), the department aims to broaden economic opportunities in agriculture, forestry, and fisheries. This, in turn, contributes to employment generation and poverty reduction. The department envisions a competitive, sustainable, and technology-based agriculture and fishery sector, driven by productive and progressive farmers and fisherfolk, supported by efficient value chains, and well-integrated in the domestic and international markets, contributing to inclusive growth and poverty reduction as they strive to help and empower the farming and fishing communities and the private sector to produce enough, accessible, and affordable food for every Filipino and a decent income for all [4], [5].

With the combined effort of farmers and the DA, the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) reported that the agricultural sector contributed 9% to the 2023 Gross Domestic Product (GDP), employing 25% of the 49.7 million Filipinos in the sector. Agriculture Secretary Francisco P. Tiu Laurel, Jr. further emphasized the need to modernize the sector to increase farmers' income, boost food security, and improve food production, aiming to contribute more to the annual GDP and enhance the country's agricultural competitiveness on a global scale [6].

The 2021 statistical report of DA Region 6 shows that the agricultural performance of the region constantly grows, as agricultural production increased by 10.28% from 2020 to 2021. The region's crops, livestock, poultry, and fisheries grew by 6.47%, 21.79%, 4.38%, and 16.06%, respectively. Although agriculture, hunting, forestry, and fishing (AHFF) decreased from 6.4% to 6% in 2021, it is still one of the leading factors for the growth of the region's economic performance. The agricultural sector contributed 23% to the region's overall economic output, gaining a 17% share from AHFF [7]. This data underscores the importance of

agriculture to economic growth, stability, and development of the region.

The DA comprises various departments, each having different roles and matters to manage. As one of its responsibilities, the planning department oversees the accreditation process for CSOs in agriculture and fisheries. To obtain accreditation, CSOs must comply with thirteen (13) documentary requirements, which serve as the cornerstone of their accreditation process (see Appendix 1) [3].

The accreditation process begins by submitting a duly accomplished accreditation application in three (3) copies by the CSO to the Regional Technical Secretariat (RTS). The RTS is then responsible for reviewing the application form and ensuring the completeness and validity of the submitted requirements [3].

Upon completion of the initial assessment, the RTS is required to publicly post certain information on their respective agency websites and in two (2) conspicuous places near the CSO's principal place of business, such as the bulletin board of the Provincial Capitol, City/Municipal

Hall, and Barangay Hall. This information includes the CSO's registered name, names of incorporators and officers, address, and the nature of services provided. The posting period is set for seven (7) days [3].

For CSO applicants at the regional level, the RTS conducts an assessment and validation before endorsing the application and deliberation of the Regional Trial Court (RTC), which is responsible for all civil cases. Suppose the CSO meets all criteria outlined in AO 13 and 19, Series of 2020, as amended. In that case, the RTC recommends the issuance of a Certificate of Accreditation to the DA Regional Executive Director (RED) within fifteen (15) working days after the RTC deliberation. However, suppose the CSO fails to meet any criteria. In that case, the National Technical Secretariat (NTS) or RTS informs the applicant in writing of the reason(s) for non-endorsement within three (3) working days after the deliberation [2], [8].

For CSOs, obtaining accreditation proves their legitimacy, opening up numerous opportunities. There are three types of accredited CSOs: co-implementers,

beneficiaries, and start-ups. Co-implementers partner with the DA in implementing projects, indicating that the department recognizes its ability and has confidence in the CSO. They are often financially stable and have partnered with the DA multiple times. Beneficiaries are CSOs who solely receive projects from the DA, while start-ups are newly founded associations. All projects from the DA are allocated to the CSO, including equipment and facilities, rather than to an individual. These accredited CSOs are categorized based on their financial stability. CSOs receive funding from the DA when collaborating on government programs or projects with a government agency or program beneficiary [3], [9].

The monitoring department is responsible for overseeing and managing all CSO projects under the DA. The department meticulously reviews and assesses project proposals submitted by CSOs to ensure that they are consistent with the DA's objectives, priorities, and guidelines. They have the authority to approve or reject proposals based on their merit and feasibility. Once approved, the department assigns projects to qualified CSOs, considering factors like

capacity, expertise, and compatibility with specific project goals.

The same department conducts regular on-site visits to monitor project progress, inspect implementation quality, and identify any challenges or alterations from the project plan. They gather and analyze project reports to determine project impact and effectiveness. The department also evaluates the performance of CSOs based on their project outcomes, timeliness, budget adherence, and overall impact on the target beneficiaries. This evaluation serves as a basis for future project assignments and resource allocation.

Each project has different Project Development Objectives (PDO) that seek to address the purpose and reason for the implementation or approval of the project. For a project to be deemed successful, it must meet the PDOs. These objectives may include factors such as whether the project is actively in use, its efficiency, and its ability to generate income for farmers [10].

There are no generic objectives, nor a one-size-fits-all. All interventions, guidelines, and objectives are specific. After the termination of the project, the monitoring department continually monitors it for months. Plaque and recognition are granted to CSOs that share best practices, showcasing their dedicated efforts and valuable contributions. These recognitions signify outstanding and impactful engagement, ultimately improving the lives of local farmers and fisherfolk [9]. This honorary award is evidence of a CSO's effective management, solidifying their good track record, and fostering trust and confidence in DA.

The duration of a project initiated by a CSO under the DA intervention program varies depending on the specific field (e.g., aquaculture, rice plantations, livestock) the CSO operates. The CSO initiates the process by filing a letter of intent or proposal. This intervention program follows a bottom-up approach, where the project duration is determined by the specifications outlined in the proposal. CSOs with the eligibility and capacity may undertake concurrent projects. Additionally, the monitoring department demands that the CSO submit Gantt charts that include

project schedules and any potential modifications to guarantee appropriate project management on their end.

Despite the significance of accreditation and project management, there is currently no dedicated system that effectively serves the needs of both parties. The absence of an integrated online web application poses challenges for both CSOs and the DA. The DA encounters difficulties in verifying whether applicants have submitted all requirements, especially when submissions are made individually rather than collectively. Moreover, the current process is time-consuming and burdensome for both parties, particularly when certain CSOs are geographically distant from the DA office.

Another significant challenge arises from the coordination issues within the RTS responsible for investigating CSOs and validating the documents required for accreditation. The RTS comprises employees from different departments, introducing complexities in streamlining the accreditation process. This lack of harmonized coordination adds a layer of difficulty to the overall accreditation process, hindering its efficiency and effectiveness.

Additionally, the lack of an integrated project management system that could track the progress of each CSO's initiatives further complicates effective oversight and coordination. This lack of comprehensive tracking mechanisms hampers the ability of both CSOs and the DA to monitor project milestones, identify potential bottlenecks, and ensure timely intervention when necessary, thereby impeding the overall success of agricultural initiatives.

In response to these challenges, our researchers are developing a web-based integrated system specifically for accrediting CSOs within the DA. This platform aims to enhance the accreditation process by providing a comprehensive and user-friendly solution. CSOs will be able to verify document quality during accreditation, renewal, and maintenance, while administrators can securely archive verified documents. It also integrates performance monitoring and project management functionalities to help the DA oversee the performance of the CSOs and also a feature that would enable the administrators to annually assess the rank of the CSO's overall performance.

The user journey begins with the registration of a CSO office account. The CSO will provide essential information such as the organization's name, registration number, email address, telephone number, address, and details of the chairperson or president. As soon as the required information is submitted, a verification email will be sent to the provided email address. Additionally, the admin will review the submitted information to verify its accuracy and authenticity. Upon completion of both the email verification and admin approval, the CSO office account will be activated.

Subsequently, a CSO representative can register under the CSO office account. They will provide their personal information and email address. The same two-step verification process applies to the representative's account. Once both verifications are complete, the representative can log in and initiate the accreditation application process.

The representative's account will manage all transactions with the DA, while the CSO office account will serve as an archive for all documents and submissions.

The system will provide a user-friendly interface for uploading, verifying, and archiving documents, aiming to improve collaboration within the DA. CSOs will have access to important documents such as notices, advisories, downloadable files, and online forms specifically designed for accreditation applications and submissions of annual accomplishments and financial reports for accredited CSOs.

These reports from CSOs will then be processed into financial performance metrics such as ROI, liquidity, and solvency. Combined with project performance, these metrics will determine the CSO's performance ranking through a weighted scoring system.

To maintain compliance, the system will implement strict measures. Users who have not complied with the required submissions or failed to meet specific criteria will be restricted from accessing certain features, such as project management tools and renewal processes. This restriction will remain in place until the user addresses the compliance issues. Additionally, the admin can also provide timely feedback to guide users in completing their submissions.

The integrated project management system within the platform will benefit both the DA and CSO. It will facilitate efficient project tracking, progress monitoring, and collaboration, ensuring timely completion of initiatives and effective resource allocation. This streamlined approach will enhance operational efficiency and decision-making for both stakeholders, ultimately leading to the successful implementation of agricultural projects.

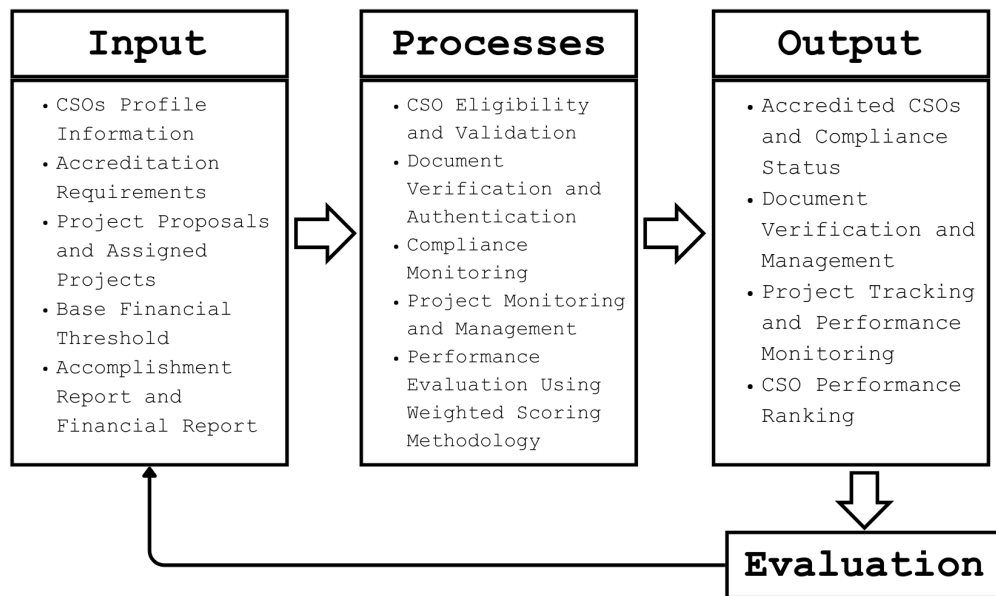


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework of the Proposed System

Objectives of the Study

The proposed study aims to develop a web-based system for the Department of Agriculture's (DA) Civil Society Organization (CSO) application for accreditation and renewal, with a primary focus on creating a streamlined and efficient process. Specifically, it aims to:

1. Develop a system that allows the DA to register, verify, and profile CSOs and their representatives.
2. Implement verification of required documents' quality during CSOs' application of accreditation and renewal and its maintenance while enabling administrators to archive verified documents securely.
3. Integrate project management and performance monitoring features into the system for CSOs accredited by the DA.
4. Incorporate features that enable administrators to annually assess the rank of CSOs' overall performance based on ROI, liquidity, solvency, and compliance utilizing weighted scoring methodology.
5. Evaluate the quality of the web-based system using ISO 25010:2011.

Significance of the Study

The proposed study has a significant impact on stakeholders in agricultural development and civil society engagement in the Philippines. The project is intended to empower CSOs, enhance collaboration between government agencies and local groups, and ultimately contribute to the socioeconomic growth of rural communities. The following highlights the importance of the study for specific organizations and individuals:

DA. The study simplifies both the accreditation process and project management through document verification, thereby enhancing the efficiency of the Department of Agriculture (DA) processes. This necessitates the strategic and transparent allocation of resources, allowing for effective project monitoring by the agency. Ultimately, this modernized approach strengthens the DA's capacity to support farmers and rural communities, paving the way for a more prosperous agricultural sector.

CSOs. This system will enhance CSOs' credibility by streamlining accreditation and project management, enabling

them to allocate more resources to community assistance and access funding opportunities more efficiently. Through the system's project management capabilities, CSOs can ensure adherence to timelines, thereby improving their performance evaluation.

Farmers. The study is intended to facilitate enhanced support for farmers. This would grant local farming communities increased access to training, market opportunities, and crucial resources for weather resilience, ultimately fostering improved livelihoods and a more sustainable agricultural sector that contributes to food security and a thriving rural community.

Other Researcher/s. Extending its impact, this study offers valuable methodologies and insights for researchers in related fields. Shared findings and best practices will fuel academic discourse, fostering knowledge exchange and inspiring further exploration in agricultural development, governance, and CSO engagement.

Delimitation of the Study

The proposed web-based system for Civil Society Organization (CSO) accreditation applications by the Department of Agriculture (DA) offers a comprehensive platform to streamline the accreditation process and enhance organizational management. In this section, the system's scope will be defined to ensure clarity and feasibility. Firstly, the focus of the system is solely on CSO accreditation applications, renewals, and maintenance within the purview of the Department of Agriculture in Region 6. While the system facilitates document upload, archiving, and analysis, it does not extend to providing legal or regulatory advice regarding CSO accreditation. Moreover, the scheduling feature for office visits is limited to coordinating time and date within the framework of DA operations and does not encompass broader scheduling functionalities. Furthermore, while the system's performance monitoring and project management features for CSOs accredited by the DA are limited to tracking project progress and categorizing project statuses. This functionality focuses on archiving and organizing projects according to their stages without conducting in-depth

content analysis or assessing the financial health and organizational capacity of CSOs. Additionally, the project management component is customized to allocate and track projects assigned to accredited CSOs within the agriculture sector exclusively, excluding functionalities for other sectors or industries. Lastly, the system incorporates features enabling administrators to annually assess the rank of CSOs' overall performance based on ROI, liquidity, solvency, and compliance using a weighted scoring methodology predefined by the DA without allowing customization beyond these parameters. With these delimitations, it ensures that the system remains focused, manageable, and aligned with the objectives and resources of the Department of Agriculture in Region 6.

Definition of Terms

The terms in this study were defined conceptually based on the definitions taken from dictionaries, books, and journals and were defined operationally referring to how these words apply to the study:

Accreditation -- is the process of officially recognizing an organization or institution to a set of standards to perform an activity or hold a certain status [11].

In this study, "Accreditation" refers to the official recognition by a government agency that confirms a CSO's adherence to established criteria and qualifications.

Admin -- is the person in charge of the operation of a computer network or a website, with the ability to make modifications to it [12].

In this study, "Admin" is used as an abbreviation for administration and refers to the person who will manage the web-based system.

Agriculture -- is the science, art, or practice of cultivating the soil, producing crops, and raising livestock, and in varying degrees, the preparation and marketing of the resulting products [13].

"Agriculture," as used in this study, refers to the sector involving farming, cultivation, and production of crops, livestock, and related activities.

Applicant -- refers to a person who formally requests something, such as a job or admission to a college or university [14].

In this study, "Applicant" is an agricultural organization seeking accreditation for funding or involvement in agricultural programs or projects.

CSO -- short for Civil Society Organization, refers to an organizational structure whose members serve the general interest through a democratic process and which plays the role of mediator between public authorities and citizens [15].

In this study, "CSO" is a registered organization or association actively involved in agricultural development and community-based initiatives.

CSO as Beneficiary -- refers to CSOs who are recipients of government projects and programs and other agencies to achieve their objectives or enhance their capacity [3].

In this study, "CSO as beneficiary" refers to an accredited CSO to obtain assistance, grants, or projects

from the DA to support their agricultural activities and/or organizational goals.

CSO as Co-implementer -- or CSO Implementing CSO, refers to an organization or association that collaborates with governmental or non-governmental agencies to jointly execute and manage projects, programs, or interventions [3].

In this study, "CSO as Co-implementer" signifies the role of a CSO partnering with the Department of Agriculture or other entities in jointly implementing agricultural projects or initiatives.

CSO as a Start-up -- refers to a newly established organization or initiative in the early stages of development and operation [3].

"CSO as a start-up," in this study, denotes a duly registered and accredited CSO that has a limited operational history and experience in agricultural activities.

DA -- short for Department of Agriculture, refers to the government agency responsible for promoting agricultural development by providing the policy framework, public investments, and support services needed for domestic and export-oriented business enterprises [5].

In this study, "DA" refers to the governmental department responsible for administering agricultural

policies, providing support, and implementing programs to enhance agricultural productivity, sustainability, and competitiveness.

Good Standing -- refers to an official document that proves that a company exists, does not owe taxes, and is legally allowed to do business in a particular area [16].

In this study, "Good standing" denotes a CSO's adherence to regulatory and organizational standards, reflecting its compliance with accreditation criteria, financial obligations, and operational guidelines.

Performance -- refers to an activity performed by a person or group to entertain an audience [17].

In this study, "Performance" refers to the effectiveness and efficiency of CSOs and agricultural projects in achieving stated objectives, outcomes, and targets, as evaluated through performance indicators and metrics.

Project -- refers to a piece of planned work or an activity that is finished over some time and intended to achieve a particular purpose [18].

In this study, a "Project" is a planned initiative or activity implemented by CSOs or the DA to address

agricultural challenges, promote development, or achieve predetermined goals and targets.

These definitions aim to provide a clear understanding of the terms used within the study, both conceptually and operationally, to facilitate comprehension and interpretation of the research context and findings.

CHAPTER 2 REVIEW OF RELATED STUDIES

Review of Existing and Related Studies

Current Systems

The Department of Agriculture is one of the Philippine government agencies tasked with promoting the nation's agricultural growth. The department's top priorities are increasing agricultural revenue and providing opportunities for farmers, fishers, and other agricultural workers [19]. To promote this development in agriculture, the Department of Agriculture will be involved with or partnered with accredited Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) to execute agri-fishery initiatives to encourage people further to participate in agricultural development to promote this development in agriculture [20].

In the application process for CSO's accreditation, there are sets of criteria required to be accomplished by the CSO that will be evaluated by the Regional Technical Secretariat (RTS) [20]. In this current system for the application process, the CSO submits the required documents physically to the regional office of the Department of Agriculture together with its application form. When the

records are forwarded to the regional office, the RTS verifies the application form and checks the completeness and validity of the requirements or documents submitted by the CSO. After the verification process, the secretariat will post some information about the CSO on their website and in two noticeable locations near the CSO's office. These locations could include bulletin boards of the Provincial Capitol, City/Municipal Hall, or Barangay Hall, and they should remain posted for 7 days. The secretariat will then conduct a background investigation and verification not later than 7 working days, and it includes authenticating the submitted documents through confirmation with the government agencies (GA). After the background investigations and verification, if CSOs lack documents or are non-compliance with any of the provisions of the administrative order, they can be subject to disapproval for the accreditation. After the RTS evaluation of the CSO, the RTS will endorse the validated CSO to be deliberated by the Regional Technical Committee (RTC). After deliberation and if the CSO has met all the criteria, the RTC will recommend the issuance Certificate of Accreditation [20].

Accredited CSOs will become either implementing partners or beneficiaries of the DA's program and projects by tapping citizen engagement through the accredited CSOs, the DA aims to promote transparency and accountability, and enhance good governance in the agricultural sector [19]. As implementing partners, accredited CSOs are given funding from the DA when they are implementing a government program or project jointly with a government agency or a beneficiary of a government program and project. The Accredited CSOs are regularly monitored and assessed by the national and regional technical committees through quarterly reports submitted to the Department of Agriculture.

Related Systems or Solutions

An accreditation system is one of the solutions that can streamline the accreditation process. The iCloudEMS [21], offers a cloud-based Accreditation Management System aimed at educational institutions, streamlining accreditation processes. This system automates data administration and formatting, aligning with accreditation standards. It simplifies the compilation of self-assessment reports, reducing time and labor. Users are guided through data input based on predefined questions and criteria,

facilitating uploading to accreditation portals. It automates report creation and qualification analyses, aiding faculty. Its structured data and assessment technique enable quick performance evaluation. The user-friendly interface enhances audits by governing bodies, improving accreditation efficiency. This accreditation process follows the Higher Education Institute (HEI) standards in accreditation, and the said system can help the institution to make the process of accreditation more efficient [22].

This study simplifies the accreditation process for CSOs by offering a straightforward application and renewal feature with an easy-to-use document upload interface. Submitted documents are immediately accessible to administrators, allowing for quick review and verification, which speeds up processing and provides CSOs with prompt feedback.

Monday.com, a project management platform, consolidates project planning, task management, and progress tracking within a centralized digital environment [23], [24]. A key feature of Monday.com is its use of boards, where users can systematically organize tasks, categorize them by project

phases, and establish specific objectives [23]. Its task management functionality offers extensive customization, allowing users to assign due dates, priorities, timelines, and dependencies, and attach relevant documents, thereby equipping team members with comprehensive information for task execution [23], [24]. The platform's versatility is further enhanced through multiple viewing options, such as Gantt, Kanban, and Calendar views, allowing visual tracking and facilitating project planning. Gantt charts notably support dependency tracking and enable comparisons of planned versus actual progress [23]. Additionally, Monday.com incorporates collaborative tools, including direct file sharing, integrated documentation, and a discussion space within boards, fostering seamless communication among team members [24]. Customizable dashboards and advanced reporting tools, including stacked charts, pivot tables, and workload views, provide data-driven insights essential for strategic decision-making [23]. Furthermore, Monday.com integrates with various third-party applications, such as Slack, Excel, and Google Drive, thus centralizing business processes within a single platform and enhancing project visibility and coordination [23], [24].

This study incorporates a project monitoring feature that enables both the Designated Administrator (DA) and Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) to effectively track the progress of ongoing projects. This feature includes a comprehensive checklist and a percentage-based progress bar, which provide clear visual indicators of completed objectives. This functionality not only helps identify which specific goals have been achieved but also assesses whether they are being met within the timelines proposed by the CSOs or established by the DA.

Related Studies

A Web-based Construction Project Performance Monitoring System (PPMS) developed by Cheung et al., was designed to facilitate project control for managers in the construction industry [25]. Through collaboration with a panel of project management specialists, key performance measure categories such as People, Cost, Time, Quality, Safety and Health, Environment, Client Satisfaction, and Communication are identified for inclusion in the PPMS. Corresponding performance indicators and measurement criteria are established for each category. Automation of the monitoring process is achieved through leveraging the World Wide Web

and database technology, enabling seamless data collection and dissemination. The implementation of the PPMS offers senior project management, project directors, and project managers a valuable tool for monitoring and assessing project performance [25].

In this study, performance monitoring will be used to monitor the CSO's performance, their project management, and how the CSO utilized the benefits given by the DA.

Adleman's study examines the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) star rating methodology for evaluating hospitals [26]. This method relies on a latent variable model, which prioritizes performance measures with a strong statistical correlation to an unobservable quality factor, assigning them greater weight [26]. However, the study identifies limitations when weaker or unrelated measures are considered, resulting in potential score instability and lower hospital ratings despite improvements [26]. In response, the paper proposes an alternative scoring framework that ensures hospitals showing relative improvement receive higher scores, with adaptable weight adjustments [26]. Departing from traditional statistical

correlation, the framework employs a conic optimization approach within data envelopment analysis, enabling concurrent efficiency analysis and performance evaluation. Theoretical exposition elucidates the framework's behavior and key properties. At the same time, empirical validation extends to a comprehensive sample of hospitals in the United States, demonstrating its potential deviation from the existing CMS star rating system [26].

In this study, weighted scoring is used to determine the CSO's annual performance ranking. Each CSO's performance is scored using a set of criteria to determine which among the CSOs performed better.

In a study by Amato *et al.*, the need for more sophisticated e-government systems capable of efficiently managing digital document repositories is addressed [26]7]. The study identifies five pivotal domains requiring attention: automatic information extraction, semantic interpretation, storage, long-term preservation, and information retrieval. Additionally, it highlights the increasing integration of multimedia data within textual information, advocating for e-government systems that can

effectively handle both modalities. To this end, the paper introduces a novel system that utilizes textual and image processing methodologies to autonomously extract insights from multimedia data, thus streamlining indexing and retrieval processes. A prototype of this system has been developed, with preliminary experimental results indicating its effectiveness in real-world scenarios [26]7].

In this study, a document management system will be implemented in the system for an organized and easy retrieval of documents when it is needed.

CHAPTER 3 RESEARCH DESIGN AND METHODOLOGY

Description of the Proposed Study

Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) play a pivotal role in promoting social welfare, agricultural development, and civic engagement. As key contributors to sustainable development endeavors, CSOs often seek accreditation from governmental agencies such as the Department of Agriculture (DA) to access resources, funding, and partnerships to support their initiatives. However, navigating the accreditation process for CSOs can be complex and resource-intensive, requiring a thorough evaluation of their performance and societal impact.

In response to the need for an integrated and transparent accreditation process, this study aims to develop a web-based system that not only enhances the accreditation process but also monitors the projects and performance of CSOs. This system utilizes document management features in conjunction with techniques to comprehensively assess, profile, and rank CSOs based on their overall performance.

Methods and Proposed Enhancements

Enhancing CSO Accreditation and Performance Evaluation

Process through Document Management: A Web-Based System for
the Department of Agriculture Region 6

This section provides a detailed exploration of the methods and enhancements employed throughout the development phase of our proposed web-based system for CSO accreditation with project tracking and performance monitoring. By delineating the approach, tools, and techniques utilized to design and implement the platform's functionalities, this section aims to offer valuable insights into the system's development process.

CSO Registration and Verification. CSOs initiate registration by providing basic organizational details through a dedicated form on the platform, which includes the organization's name, address, email, and phone number. Subsequently, personnel from the agency will verify the provided information manually, ensuring the authenticity of CSOs before granting access to the platform.

Document Upload and Storage. Upon application, renewal, and accreditation, CSOs can upload essential documents for verification, including financial statements and reports, via the front-end interface. The documents are then validated by the admin, and securely stored within the platform's database, ensuring accessibility and confidentiality as per organizational requirements.

Scheduling. CSOs can schedule office visits or necessary appointments which are essential for the submission of physical documents. With this functionality, it streamlines communication and coordination between CSOs and the agency, enhancing efficiency and convenience.

Project Management. Admins allocate or assign projects to accredited CSOs, and CSOs can track project details and progress on their respective projects tab. This seamless integration facilitates effective collaboration and project management between stakeholders.

Performance Ranking. Admins can access the performance ranking feature leveraged by weighted scoring via the dashboard to visualize the rank of CSOs based on the default

or customized performance metrics. Weighted goal programming (WGP) will be utilized for the ranking. WGP manages several conflicting goals by extending linear programming. It handles multiple objectives, minimizing deviations from target values using an achievement function. This helps decision-makers balance goals based on their importance [27].

Components and Design

Software Architecture

The software architecture provides a comprehensive overview of the constituent software elements within the proposed system [28]. As the CSO registers and uploads the documents to the website through the Internet, all verified data will be stored in the database and managed by the database manager or system admin.

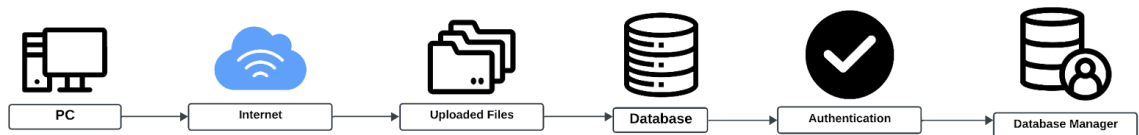


Figure 2. Software Architectural Design of the Proposed System

System Architecture

As shown in Figure 3, the system architecture begins with CSO Representatives registering in the system. Following registration, the Administrator reviews each application and once approved, activates the account. Verified accounts allow CSO representatives to upload necessary documents for their accreditation applications.

Upon successful application or renewal of accreditation, accredited CSOs are required to submit annual financial statements and accomplishment reports. These submissions undergo weighted goal programming to evaluate and rank CSOs based on their performance metrics. The database securely stores and organizes all verified documents and uploaded data, ensuring they are profiled to align with the ISO/EIC 5010 standards.

Additionally, the system's database maintains project proposals, details, and performance weights for ranking purposes. This data is accessible to the Administrator, who can oversee CSO profiles, track document compliance, and monitor performance rankings through the system's dashboard. The comprehensive storage and organization of data enable

systematic profiling and support accurate,
standards-compliant performance assessments.

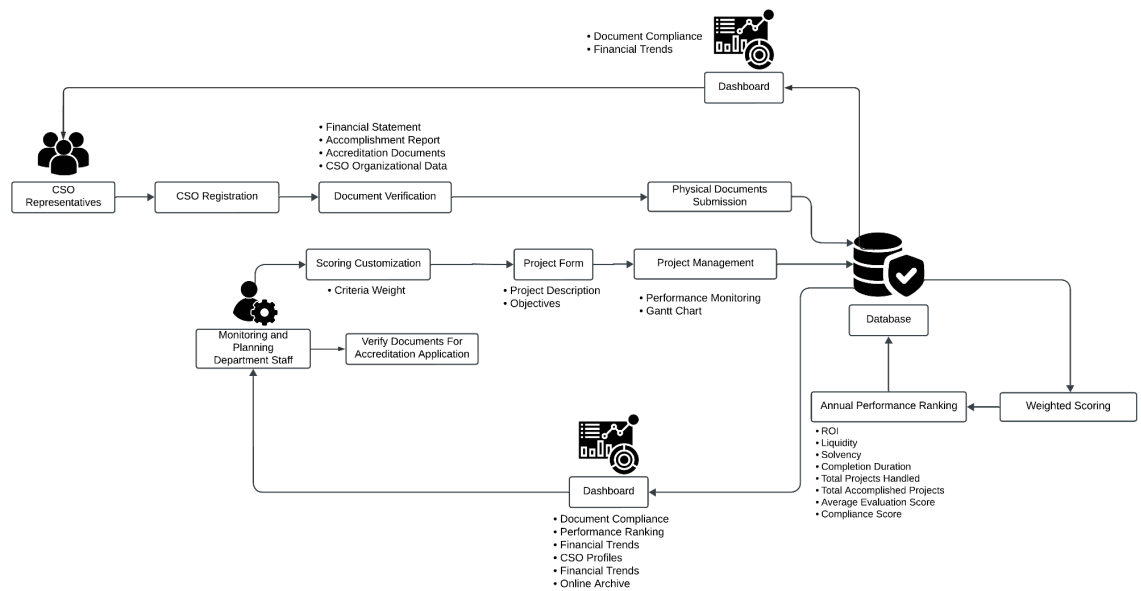


Figure 3. System Architectural Design of the Proposed System

Database Design

Database design serves as a fundamental guideline for researchers, facilitating the systematic organization of data in alignment with the designated database model [29]. This diagram aims to discern the requisite variables essential for the MySQL database and the pertinent inputs necessary for the system.

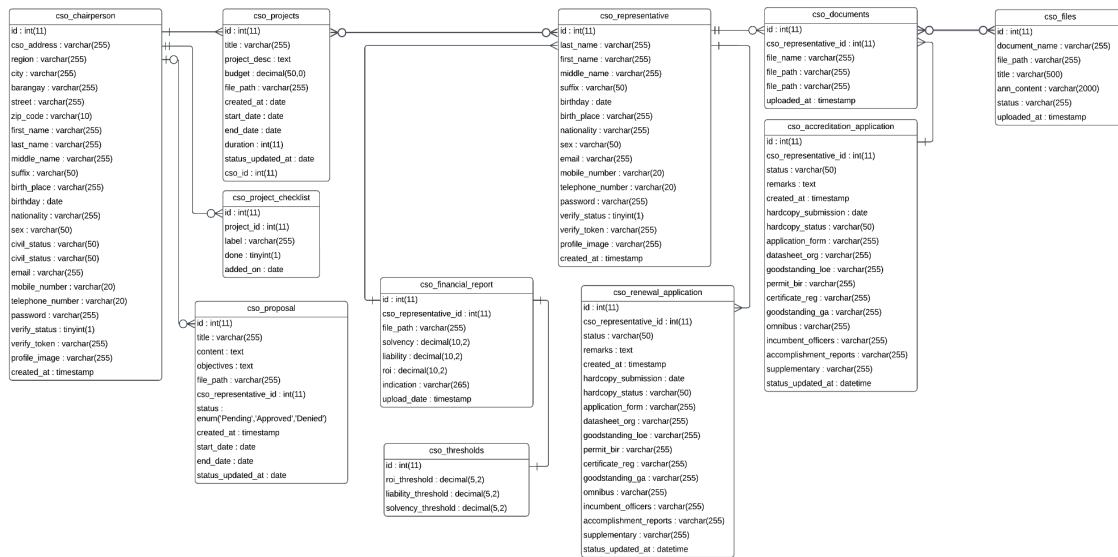
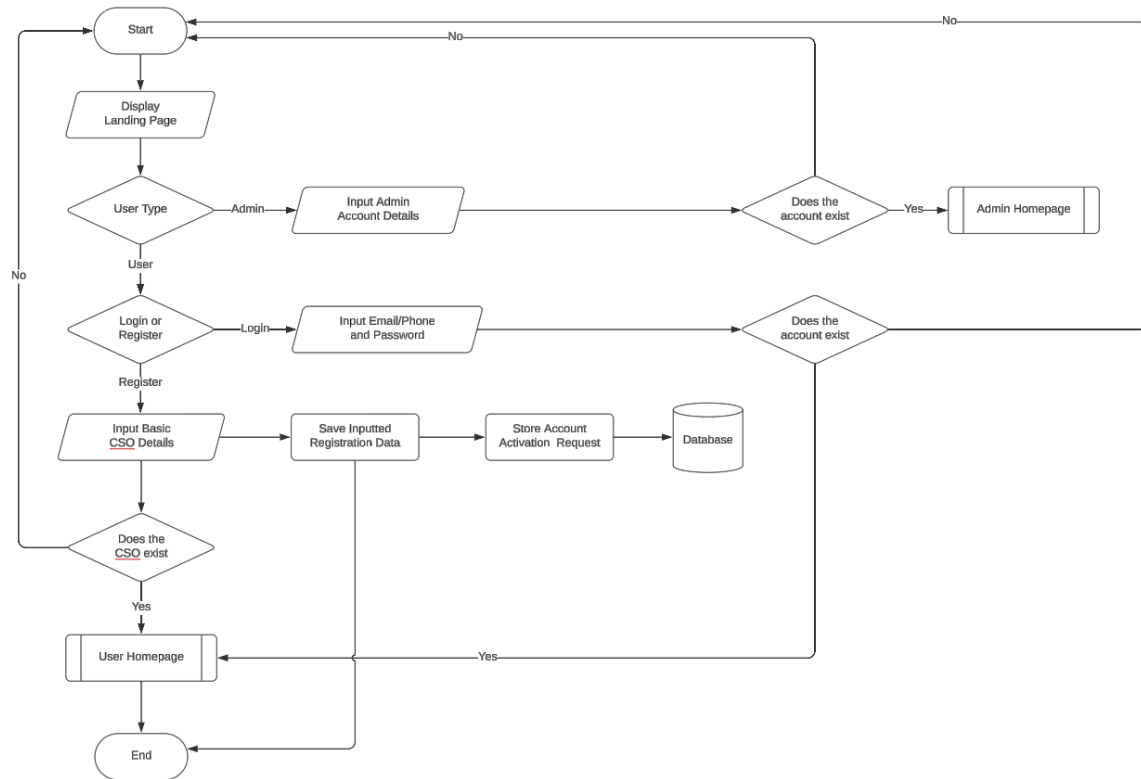


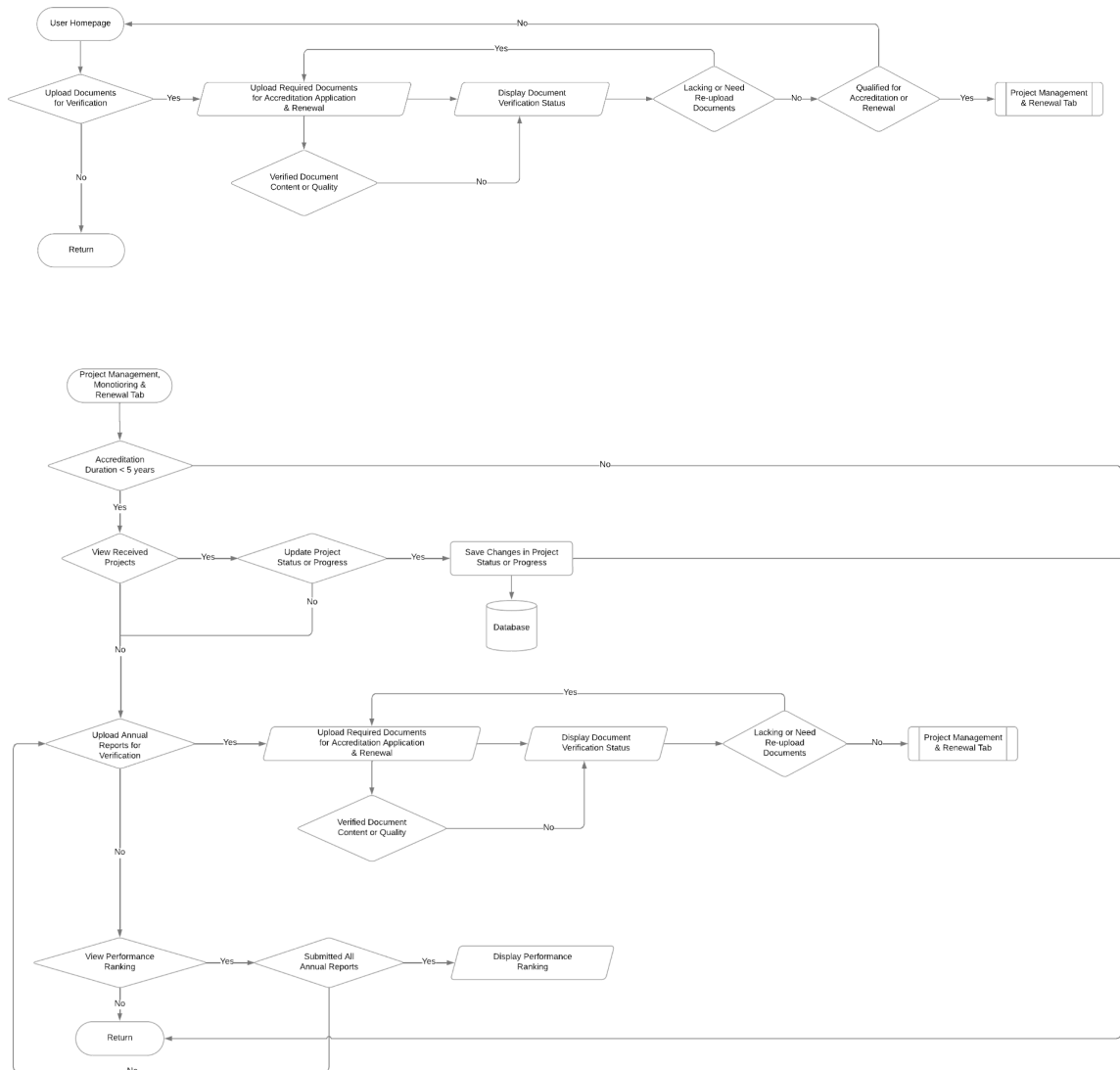
Figure 4. Database Design of the Proposed System

Procedural Design

Procedural design portrays the sequence of actions within the envisioned system and delineates the processes involved in storing, modifying, and updating data. Such a presentation aims to facilitate comprehension among end users regarding the operational dynamics and functionalities of the system [30].



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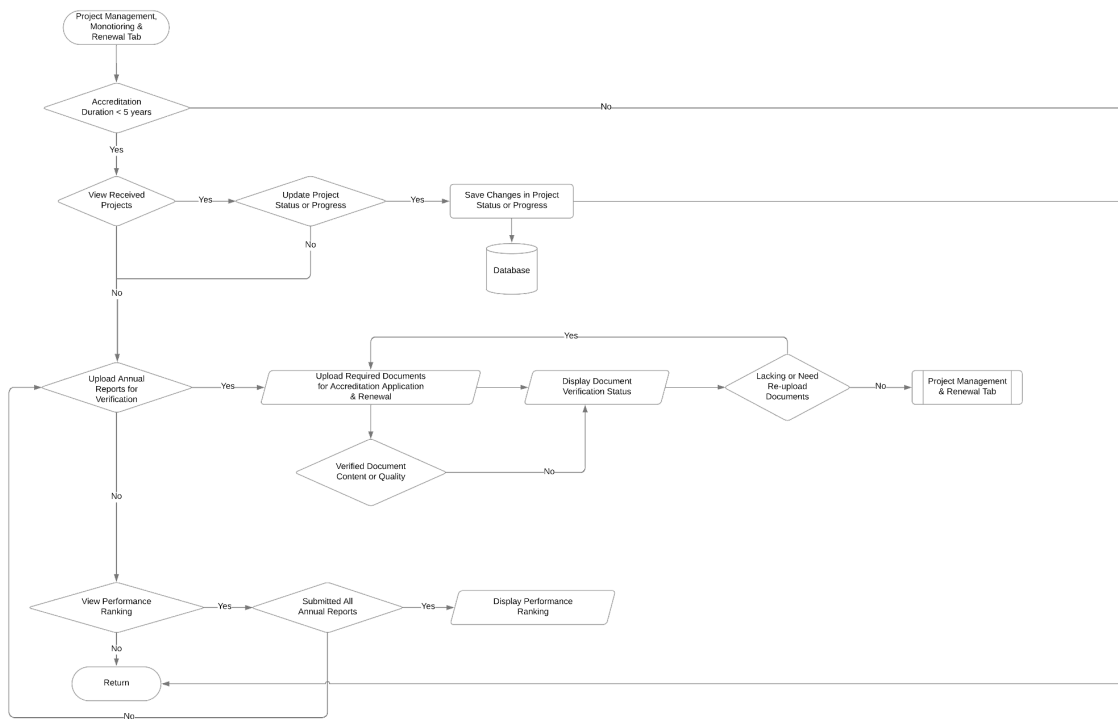


Figure 5. Procedural Design of the Proposed System

Object-Oriented Designs

As shown in Figure 6, the system starts with CSO representatives registering and submitting initial documents for account activation. Once verified and activated by an administrator, users can upload required accreditation documents, such as financial statements and accomplishment reports. These documents are reviewed by the Monitoring and Planning Department for compliance, and verified documents are securely stored in the database. Upon approval, the CSO

gains accredited status and can submit ongoing reports and project data.

Accredited CSOs submit annual performance reports, which are evaluated through a weighted scoring system based on metrics like ROI and project completion. All verified documents and performance data are stored to generate compliance profiles and rankings, accessible to administrators. The system also provides a dashboard for tracking CSO compliance, submissions, and accreditation status, supporting efficient oversight and data management.

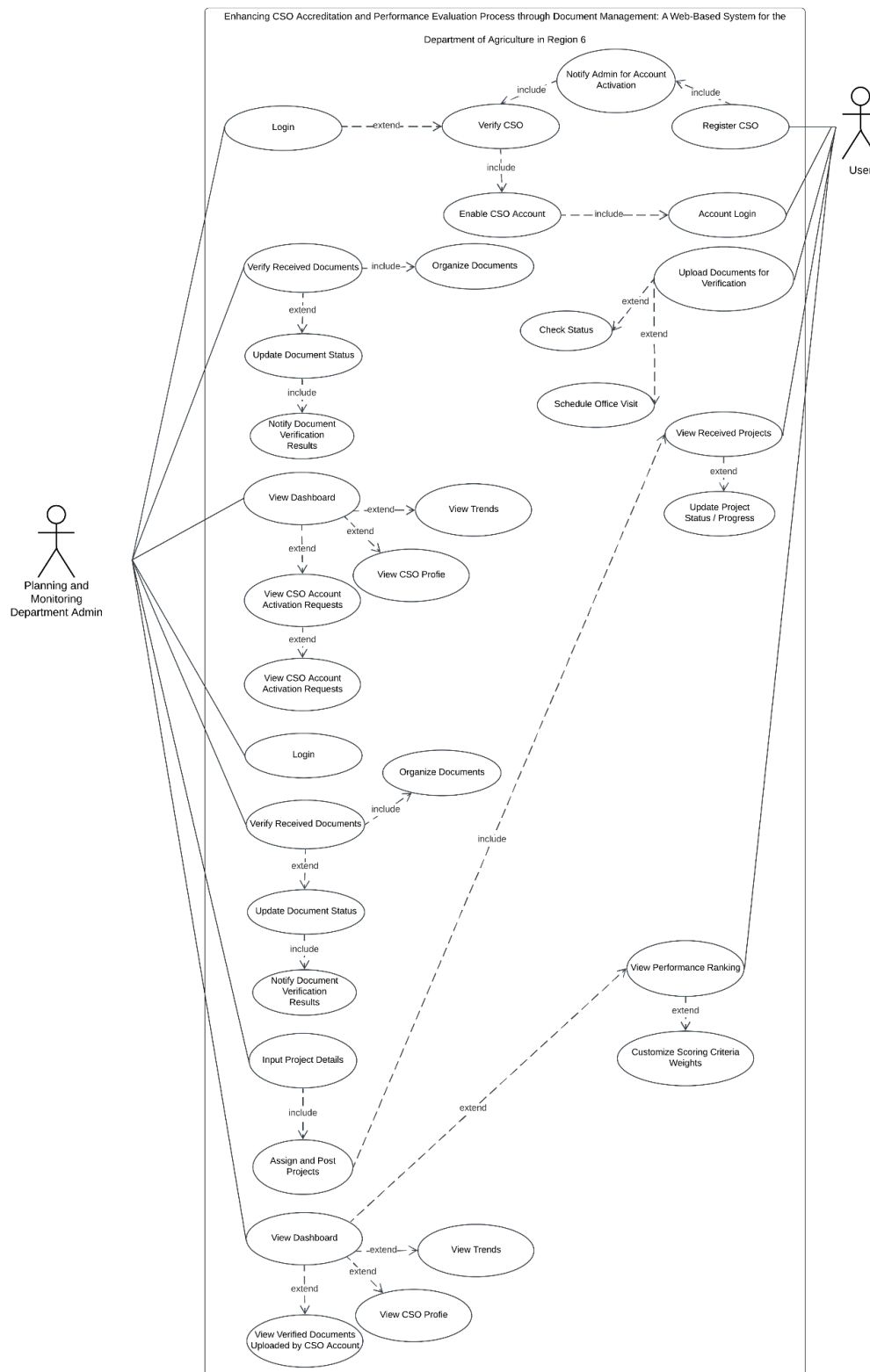


Figure 6. Use Case Design of the Proposed System

Figure 7 illustrates the process workflow for handling a case, project, or transaction. It includes several key stages, starting with an initial process in the leftmost lane, which involves assessment and documentation steps. The middle section features decision points that lead to further actions, such as reviewing, verifying, and approving certain details. Each decision point guides the process down specific paths based on the outcome, while some paths loop back to earlier stages for re-evaluation. The rightmost lane likely represents finalization activities, where conditions are checked, and the process is either completed or escalated as needed. This setup ensures a structured flow, moving through each step systematically, and providing checkpoints to maintain accuracy and compliance.

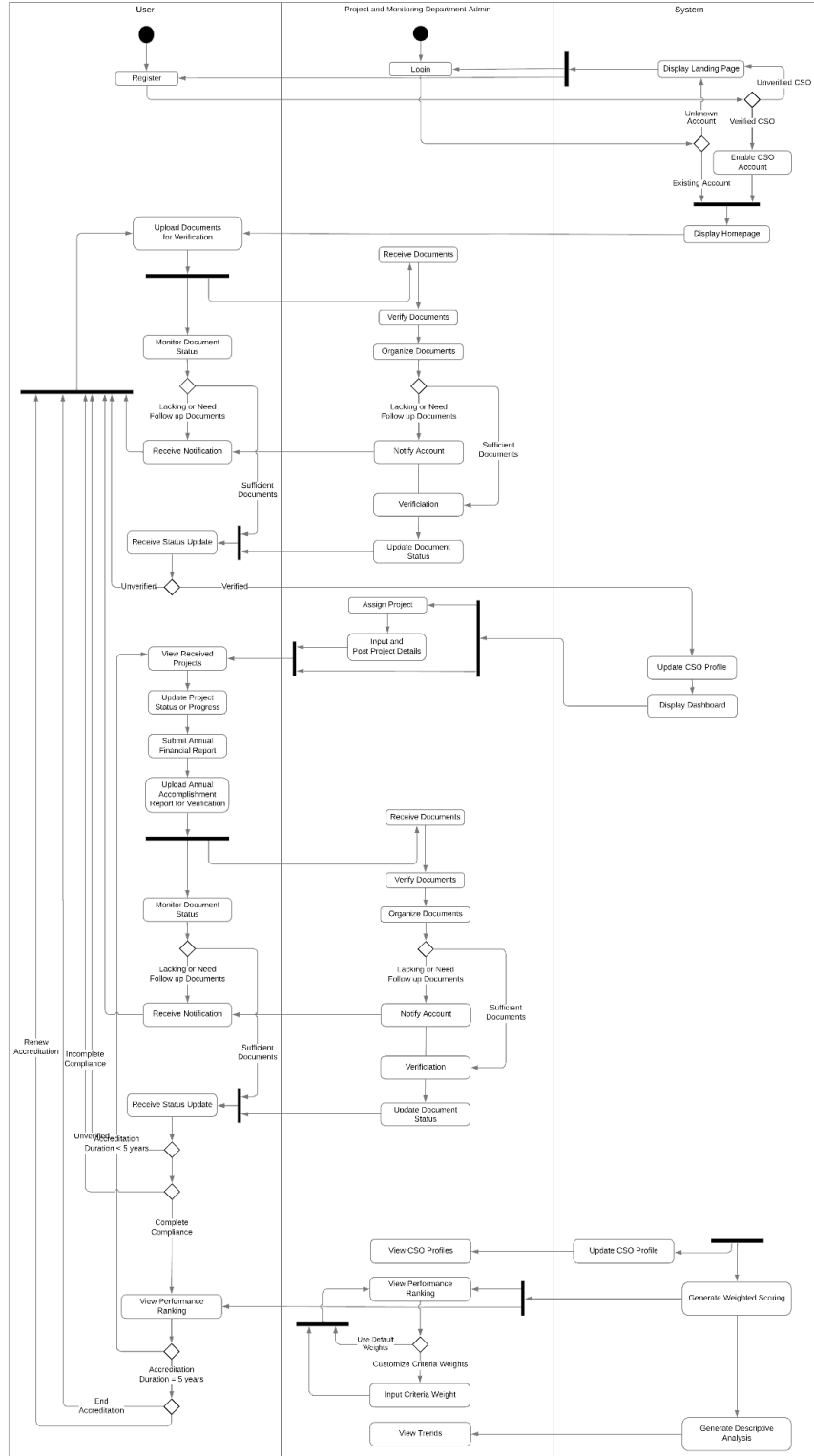


Figure 7. Activity Design of the Proposed System

Process Design

Data Flow Diagrams (DFD) delineate the flow of data and processes within the envisaged system, illustrating how information is transmitted, transformed, and stored. This graphical representation aids in comprehending the sequence of activities and their interrelationships, facilitating a clear understanding of system functionality for end users [31].

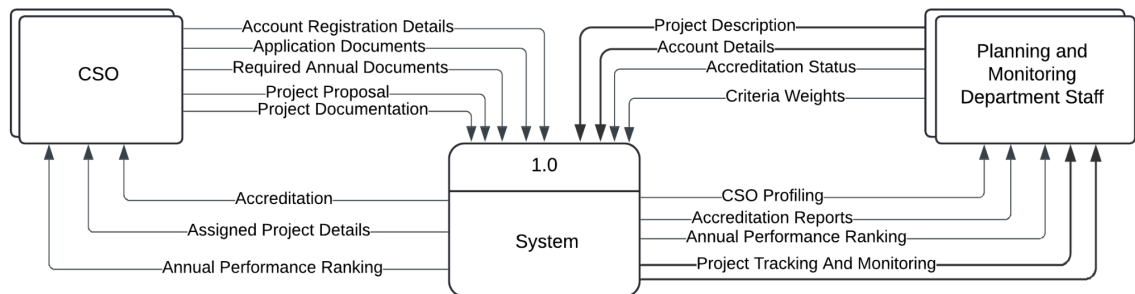


Figure 8. Data Flow Diagram of the Proposed System

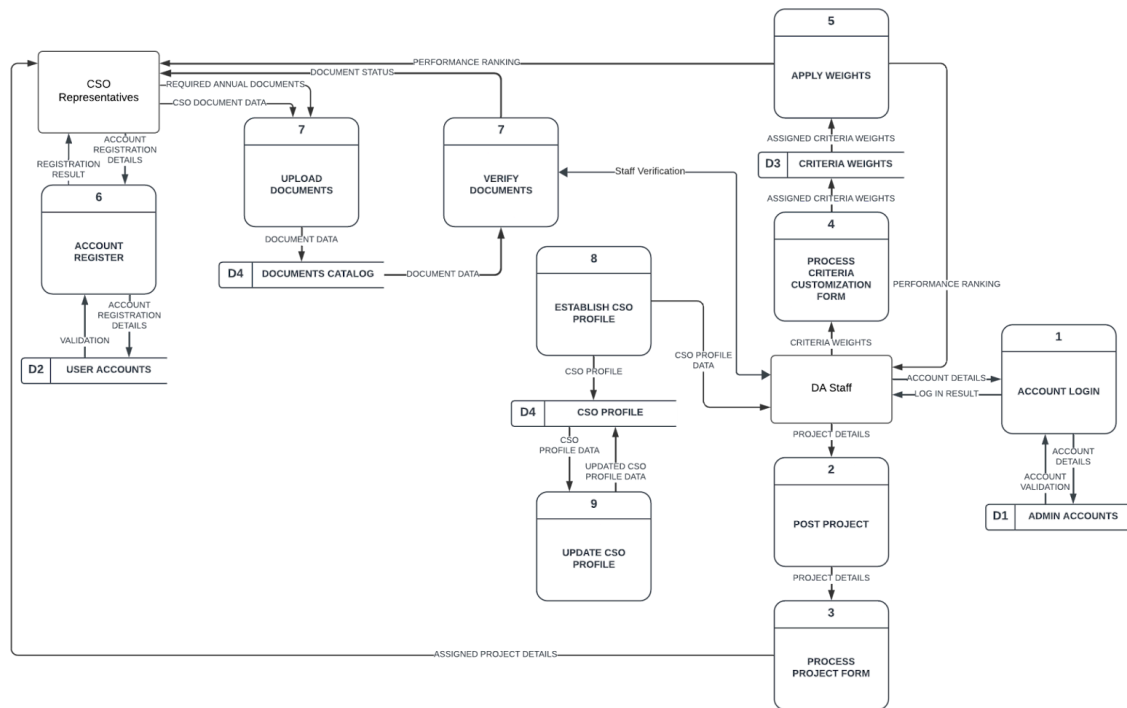


Figure 9. Process Design of the Proposed System

Methodology

System Development Life Cycle

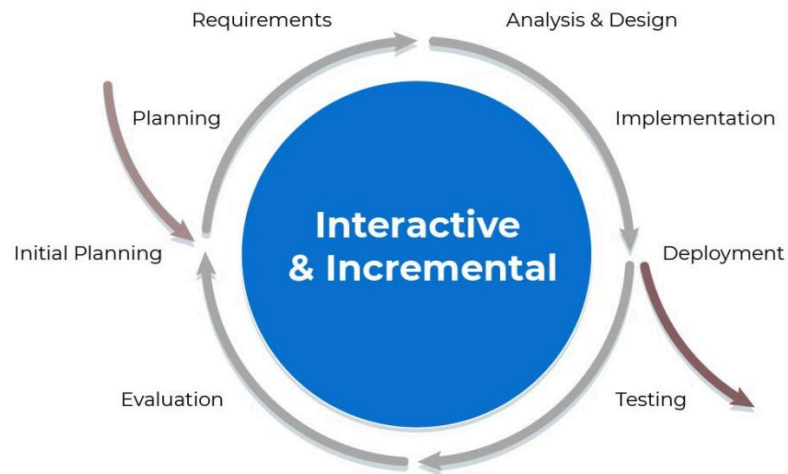


Figure 10. Methodology for the Proposed System

The Iterative and Incremental Development (IID) model is the approach used due to the complexity and evolving nature of the project's requirements [32]. Given the diverse range of features involved, including user registration, document upload, scheduling, descriptive analysis, and weighted scoring, breaking down the development process into smaller, manageable iterations is essential. This approach allows for the gradual refinement and enhancement of each functionality over time, ensuring that stakeholders' evolving needs and expectations are effectively addressed. Additionally, IID enables continuous feedback from

stakeholders, including CSOs, DA representatives, and administrators, which is crucial for validating the system's functionality and ensuring alignment with the project's objectives. By delivering increments of the system at regular intervals, potential risks and issues can be identified early on and mitigated promptly, contributing to the overall success of the project.

CHAPTER 4 RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Implementation

This section provides detailed insights into the development and operational aspects of the system, outlining the development tools, hardware, and software requirements needed.

Development Tools

The system was developed using the Visual Studio Code IDE, which provides tools for writing, debugging, and deploying code [33]. The languages utilized include PHP, which is a server-side scripting language commonly used for web development [34]; JavaScript, a versatile programming language often used for client-side scripting in web development [35]; and Bootstrap, a front-end framework for developing responsive and mobile-first websites [36].

For database management, MySQL was employed. MySQL is an open-source relational database management system (RDBMS) that allows for efficient storage and retrieval of data [37].

To aid in the visualization and design of the system's user interface and architecture, the developers utilized Figma and Lucidchart. Figma is a collaborative interface design tool used for creating wireframes, prototypes, and UI designs, while Lucidchart is a diagramming software that enables the creation of flowcharts, diagrams, and visual representations of system architecture [38], [39].

Hardware Requirements

The system requires standard hardware components such as personal computers (PCs) or laptops to access and interact with the platform. These devices should have sufficient processing power, memory, and storage capacity to handle the system's operations efficiently. Additionally, a stable internet connection is essential to ensure seamless communication between the users' devices and the online platform. Access to a reliable WiFi network further enhances connectivity, enabling users to access the system from various locations without interruption. Meeting these hardware requirements enables users to efficiently utilize the system, streamlining the processes and fostering collaboration among the DA and CSOs.

Software Requirements

The system requires compatibility with various operating systems, such as Windows 10, Linux, and macOS. Additionally, users need access to modern web browsers such as Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, or Safari to interact with the web-based application effectively. These prerequisites ensure accessibility and seamless functionality of the system across different platforms.

Input and Outputs of the Study

The following figures are screenshots of the system.

Figure 11 shows the Landing Page where they can access the website.

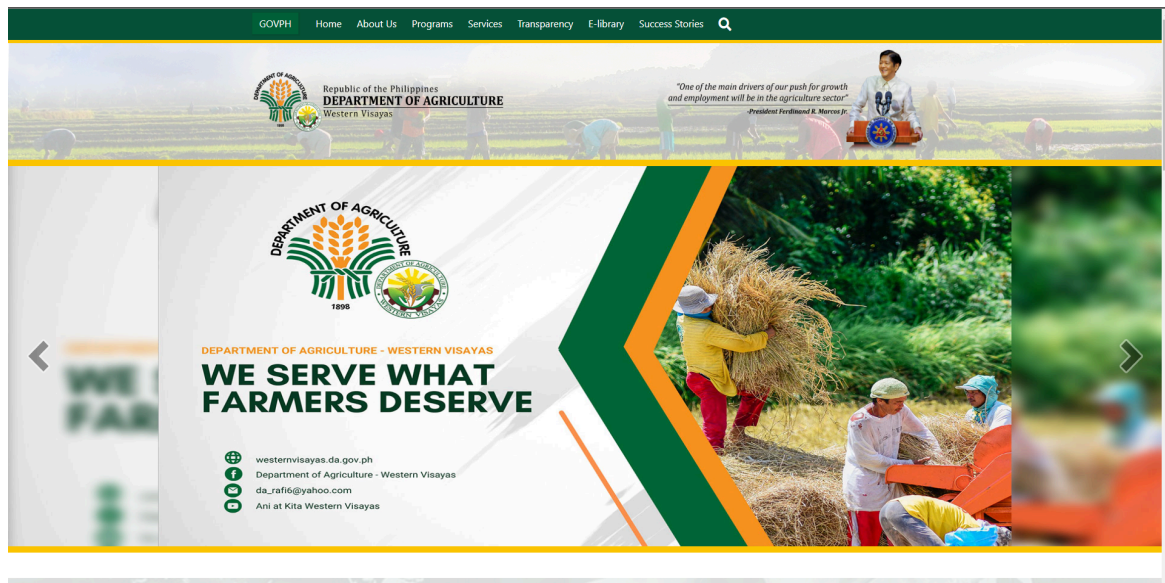


Figure 11. Landing Page(1)

Figure 12 shows an informational section of your system's landing page, detailing the process and benefits of CSO accreditation in the Department of Agriculture, alongside public advisories and accreditation status updates.



Why Apply for Accreditation?

Applying for accreditation as a Civil Society Organization (CSO) within the Department of Agriculture opens doors to a multitude of advantages. It's not just a bureaucratic process; it's a strategic move that can elevate the organization's status and impact in numerous ways.

Firstly, accreditation serves as a badge of honor, signaling the CSO's unwavering commitment to upholding high standards of operation and ethics. This commitment enhances the organization's credibility and trustworthiness among stakeholders, including farmers, donors, and partnering agencies.

Accredited CSOs also enjoy tangible benefits, such as increased access to resources, funding, and support networks. These resources are instrumental in expanding the CSO's projects and initiatives, allowing them to tackle agricultural challenges more effectively and on a larger scale.

Furthermore, accreditation paves the way for fruitful collaborations with government agencies and other partners. By establishing formal relationships, CSOs can leverage the expertise and resources of these entities, fostering innovation and advocacy for policies that benefit rural communities.

In essence, accreditation is more than just a certification; it's a strategic step towards enhancing the impact and sustainability of agricultural development initiatives. It positions CSOs as key players in the field, empowering them to drive positive change and contribute meaningfully to the advancement of agriculture and rural livelihoods.

[Apply for Accreditation](#) [Download Form](#)

Public Advisories

READ! DA-BAI Memorandum Circular No. 25
Waiving of Avian Influenza Testing per shipment of live poultry, other bird species, eggs and poultry products and by-products except live ducks coming from Region VI (Western Visayas) for local movement purposes until July 30, 2024 only.

[View >>](#)

CSO Accreditation Status

CSOs in Region 6 are pivotal forces in community development and rural welfare advocacy. Accreditation from the DA solidifies their adherence to established standards and guidelines, granting them increased legitimacy and credibility. This recognition opens doors to resources, partnerships, and government support, validating their contributions and fostering collaboration. With accredited status, these CSOs are empowered to advocate for farmers' needs, drive community-driven initiatives, and propel socio-economic progress in the region.

[View >>](#)

Elevating Excellence: CSO Accreditation in the Department of Agriculture

Accreditation is a vital process that ensures government agencies, including the Department of Agriculture, adhere to high standards of excellence, accountability, and transparency in public service. This accreditation is crucial in enhancing the efficiency and effectiveness of agricultural programs and services.

Accreditation brings several benefits to the Department of Agriculture. Firstly, it significantly improves service delivery by ensuring that employees are well-trained and equipped with the necessary skills to provide high-quality services to farmers and other stakeholders. Additionally, the accreditation process promotes accountability and transparency within the department, ensuring that resources are used efficiently and ethically.

The process of CSO accreditation involves several key steps. The department undergoes a thorough assessment of its current practices, policies, and procedures. This assessment includes evaluating staff performance, resource management, and service delivery. Based on the assessment, targeted training and development programs are implemented to address identified gaps and enhance staff competencies. The department then adopts best practices and standards in public service, aligning all operations with the principles of good governance. Continuous monitoring, audits, and reviews are conducted to ensure compliance with accreditation standards and to identify areas for further improvement.

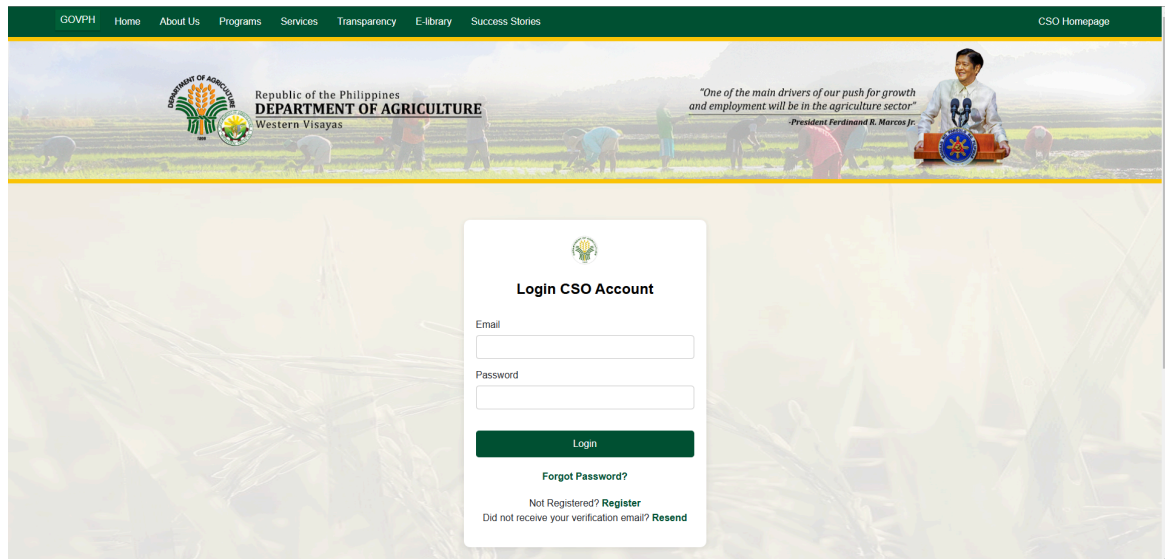
The benefits of accreditation to the Department of Agriculture are numerous. Accredited practices streamline operations, reduce wastage, and improve overall efficiency in service delivery. Accreditation also optimizes resource management, ensuring that funds and materials are allocated appropriately and effectively. Moreover, recognition through accreditation boosts staff morale and motivation, fostering a culture of excellence and dedication. Stakeholders, including farmers and suppliers, are more likely to engage with and support an accredited department, knowing that it upholds high standards.

Accreditation is not just a mark of quality but a commitment to continuous improvement and excellence in public service. By adhering to accreditation standards, the department can better serve the agricultural community, promote sustainable practices, and contribute to the overall development of the sector.

Figure 12. Landing Page(2)

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Figure 13 shows the login page of your system for CSO accounts, featuring fields for email and password, along with options for registration and password recovery.



GOVPH Home About Us Programs Services Transparency E-library Success Stories CSO Homepage

DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE
Western Visayas

"One of the main drivers of our push for growth and employment will be in the agriculture sector"
-President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.

Login CSO Account

Email

Password

Login

Forgot Password?

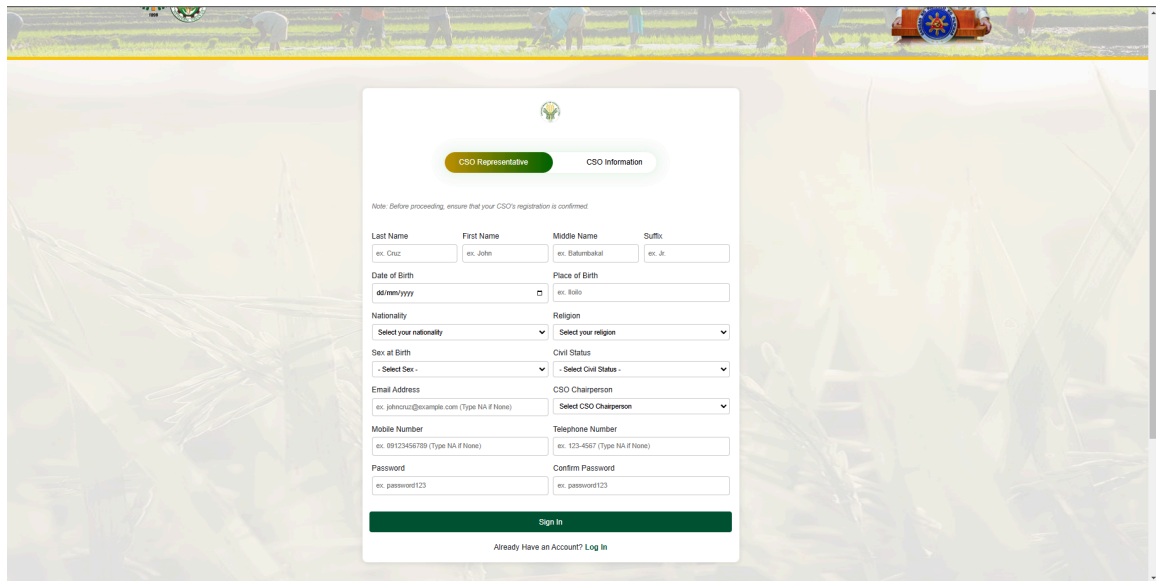
Not Registered? [Register](#)

Did not receive your verification email? [Resend](#)

Figure 13. Login Page

Figure 14 shows the registration form interface for a CSO representative.

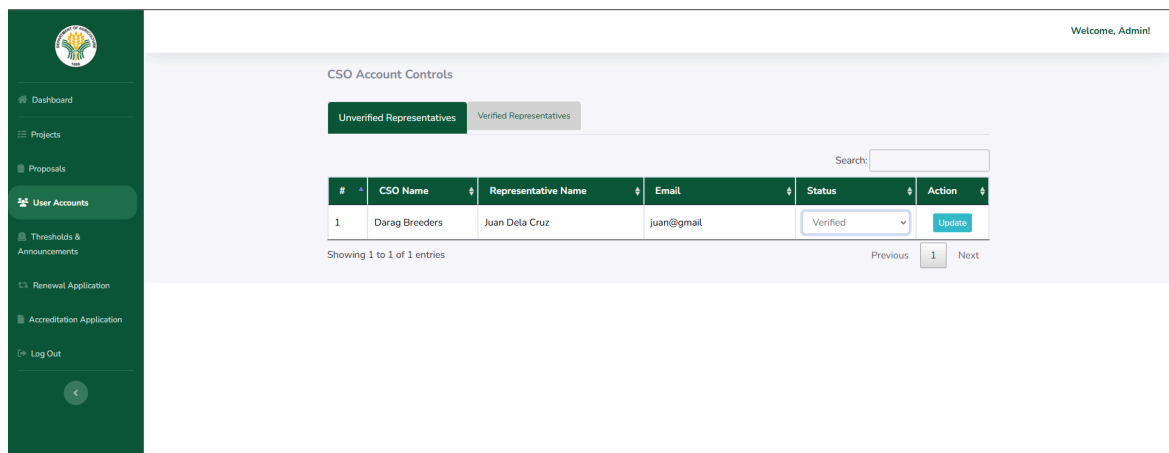
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The image shows a web-based registration form for a CSO Representative. The form is titled "CSO Representative" and "CSO Information". It includes a note: "Note: Before proceeding, ensure that your CSO's registration is confirmed." The form fields are organized into two columns. The left column contains: Last Name (ex. Cruz), First Name (ex. John), Middle Name (ex. Batumbakal), Suffix (ex. Jr), Date of Birth (ex. dd/mm/yyyy), Nationality (dropdown: Select your nationality), Sex at Birth (dropdown: Select Sex), Email Address (ex. johnacruz@example.com), Mobile Number (ex. 09123456789), Password (ex. password123), and a "Sign In" button. The right column contains: Place of Birth (ex. Iloilo), Religion (dropdown: Select your religion), Civil Status (dropdown: Select Civil Status), CSO Chairperson (dropdown: Select CSO Chairperson), Telephone Number (ex. 123-4567), and Confirm Password (ex. password123). Below the "Sign In" button is a link: "Already Have an Account? Log In".

Figure 14. Registration of CSO Representative

Figure 15 shows the registration form interface for a CSO (Civil Society Organization) office.



The image shows the "CSO Account Controls" interface. It features a sidebar on the left with a green background and white text, containing a logo and a list of menu items: Dashboard, Projects, Proposals, User Accounts (highlighted), Thresholds & Announcements, Renewal Application, Accreditation Application, and Log Out. The main content area has a header "Welcome, Admin!" and a title "CSO Account Controls". Below the title are two tabs: "Unverified Representatives" (active) and "Verified Representatives". A search bar is located above a table. The table has columns: #, CSO Name, Representative Name, Email, Status, and Action. It contains one entry: #1, Darag Breeders, Juan Dela Cruz, juan@gmail.com, Status: Verified (dropdown), and Action: Update (button). Below the table, it says "Showing 1 to 1 of 1 entries". At the bottom right of the table area are "Previous", "1", and "Next" buttons.

Figure 15. Registration of CSO Office

Figure 16 shows the admin account control interface for managing CSO representative accounts, including options to verify or update user status.

Figure 16. Admin Account Controls

Figure 17 shows an email verification message received from the CSO accreditation website in a Gmail inbox.

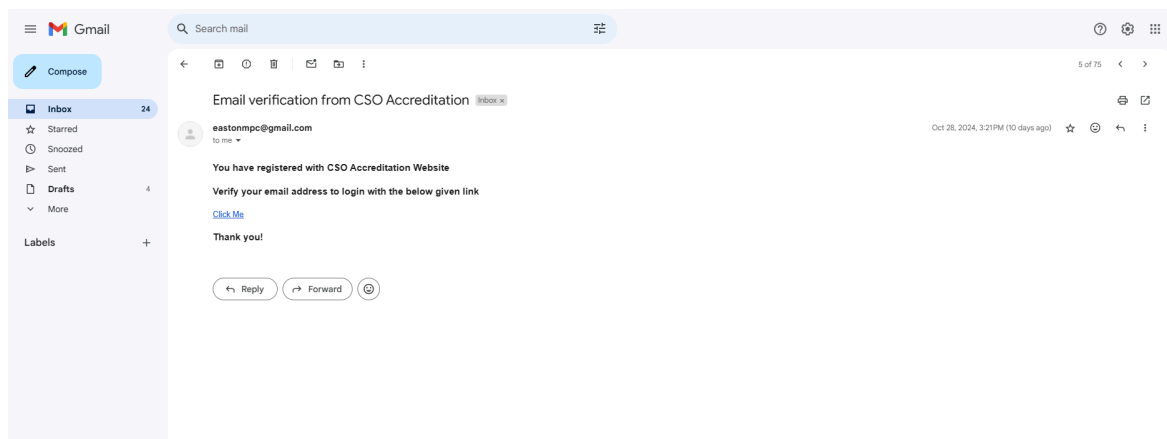


Figure 17. Email Verification

Figure 18 shows the CSO account login page with a message indicating that the email has already been verified and prompting the user to log in.

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CSO Representative

CSO Information

CSO Chairperson Information

Last Name	First Name	Middle Name	Suffix
ex. Aquino	ex. Jane	ex. Legarda	ex. Sr.

Date of Birth	Place of Birth
dd/mm/yyyy	ex. Aklan

Nationality	Religion
Select your nationality	Select your religion

Sex at Birth	Civil Status
- Select Sex -	- Select Civil Status -

Mobile Number

CSO Office Information

Name

Address

Region	Province	Municipality/City
Region VI	ex. Iloilo	ex. Iloilo City

Barangay	Street	Zip Code
ex. Barangay 1	ex. Elm Street	ex. 5000

Telephone Number	Email Address
ex. 123-4567 (Type NA if None)	ex. janeaquino@example.com (Type NA if None)

Password	Confirm Password
ex. password123	ex. password123

Sign In

Already Have an Account? Log In

Figure 18. Successful Email Verification

Figure 19 shows the CSO Representative Dashboard, displaying sections for project information, proposal status, and project status in a graphical format.

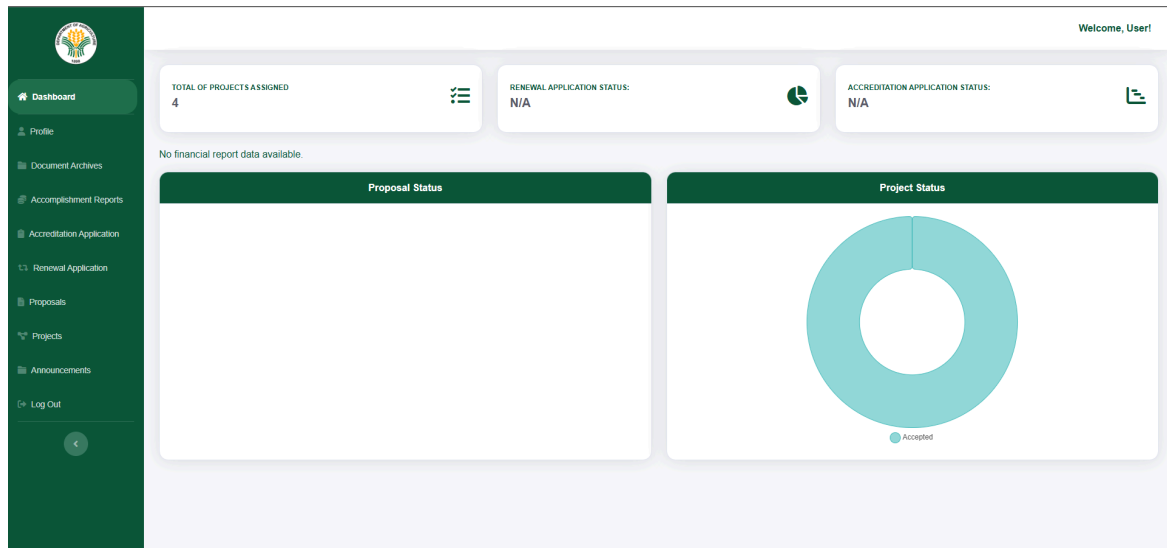


Figure 19. CSO Representative Dashboard

Figure 20 shows the "CSO Representative Profile" tab of a web application interface, where a user can view and update their profile information.

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The screenshot shows a web application interface for a user profile. On the left is a dark green sidebar with a logo at the top and a list of menu items: Dashboard, Profile (highlighted), Document Archives, Accomplishment Reports, Accreditation Application, Renewal Application, Proposals, Projects, Announcements, and Log Out. The main content area has a light gray background. At the top right, it says 'Welcome, User!'. Below this is a profile card with a circular placeholder for a profile picture. Under the picture are two buttons: 'Choose File' (disabled, showing 'No file chosen') and 'Upload Image' (active, green). Below the profile card is the 'Account Information' section, which includes an 'Email' field with the value 'user@gmail.com' and an 'Account Created' timestamp of '2024-10-16 22:04:43'. Below that is the 'CSO Representative Profile' section, which contains several input fields and dropdown menus: 'Last Name' (Dela Cruz), 'First Name' (Juan), 'Middle Name' (Reyes), 'Suffix' (empty), 'Birthday' (25/10/2003), 'Birth Place' (Valenzuela City), 'Nationality' (Filipino), 'Religion' (Christianity), 'Sex at Birth' (Male), and 'Civil Status' (Single).

Figure 20. CSO Representative Profile Tab

Figure 21 shows a web form for applying for accreditation, where users enter organization and representative details and attach necessary documents.

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The screenshot shows a web application interface for applying for accreditation. On the left is a dark green sidebar with a logo at the top and a list of menu items: Dashboard, Profile, Document Archives, Accomplishment Reports, Accreditation Application (highlighted), Renewal Application, Proposals, Projects, Announcements, and Log Out. The main content area is white and titled 'Apply for Accreditation'. It includes a welcome message 'Welcome, User!' in the top right corner. The form contains several sections: 'CSO Office Information' with fields for CSO Name, CSO Address, Region, Province, City, Barangay, Street, and Zip Code; 'Chairperson' with fields for Last Name, First Name, and Middle Name; 'Documentary Requirements' with a link to download the DA-CSO Application Form and a 'Choose File' button for the scanned form; and 'Accomplished Data Sheet with Organizational Set-up'.

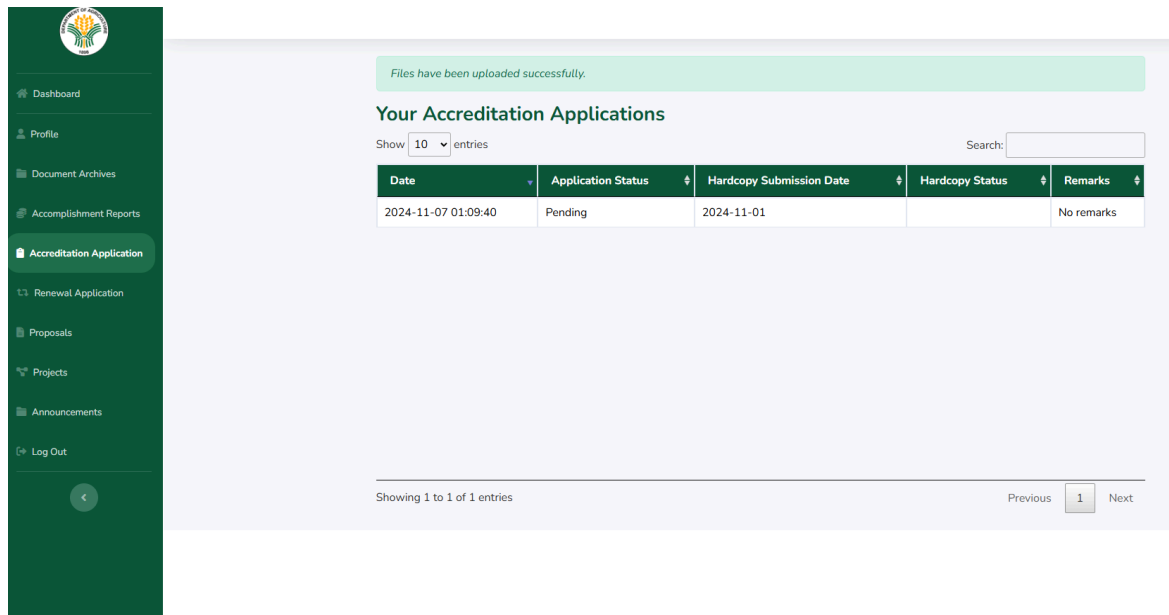
Figure 21. Applying for Accreditation

Figure 22 displays the document upload section within the accreditation application, allowing users to attach required files for compliance and submission.

The screenshot shows the 'Uploading of Documentary Requirement' section of the accreditation application. It features a sidebar identical to Figure 21. The main content area is white and lists several required documents, each with a 'Choose File' button and a 'No file chosen' status: 'Certificate of Good Standing from Government Agencies', 'Omnibus Sworn Statement (duly Notarized)', 'Secretary's Certificate of Incumbent Officers', 'Accomplishment report for the last three (3) years', and 'Supplementary Documents'. The 'Supplementary Documents' section includes a list of required items: 'Copy of Bio-data sheet with recent photo of current President/Chairman', 'Articles of Incorporation/Cooperation latest amend by law, showing the original incorporators/organizers', 'Disclosure by the CSO Directors and its Trustees of other related business, if any and extent of ownership therein', and 'Sworn Affidavit of the Secretary of CSO that none of its incorporators, organizers, directors or official is an agent of, or related by consanguinity or affinity up to the fourth civil degree to the officials of the implementing agency who are authorized to process accreditation application'. At the bottom, there is a 'Hardcopy Submission Date' field with a date picker set to 'dd/mm/yyyy' and a 'Submit Application' button.

Figure 22. Uploading of Documentary Requirement

Figure 23 displays the user's accreditation application status, showing submission details, status, and remarks.



The screenshot shows a web application interface for accreditation applications. On the left is a dark green sidebar with a logo at the top and a list of navigation items: Dashboard, Profile, Document Archives, Accomplishment Reports, Accreditation Application (highlighted), Renewal Application, Proposals, Projects, Announcements, and Log Out. The main content area has a light purple background. At the top, a green notification bar says "Files have been uploaded successfully." Below this is the heading "Your Accreditation Applications". There is a "Show" dropdown set to "10" and a "Search:" input field. A table displays the application status:

Date	Application Status	Hardcopy Submission Date	Hardcopy Status	Remarks
2024-11-07 01:09:40	Pending	2024-11-01		No remarks

At the bottom, it says "Showing 1 to 1 of 1 entries" and has pagination controls: "Previous", "1" (selected), and "Next".

Figure 23. Accreditation Status

Figure 24 shows the admin interface for verifying new accreditation applications, where admins can review and take actions on submissions.

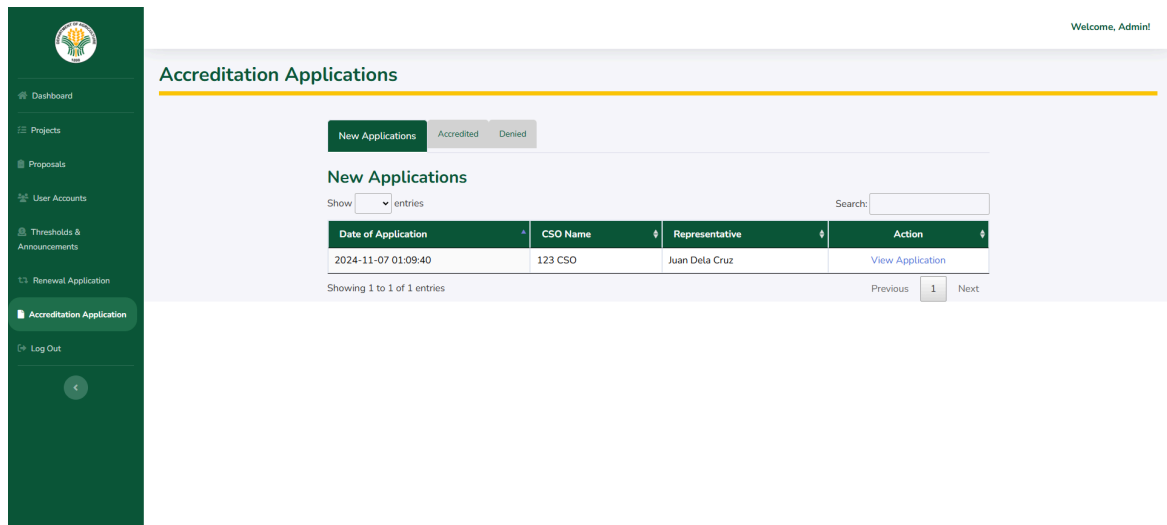


Figure 24. Admin Verification of Documents

Figure 25 shows the admin interface for updating the accreditation status of an application, including options to change status and add remarks.

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Chairperson: Symphonyxia Sy Cruz
CSO Email: maryhope.tabunlupa@wvvsu.edu.ph
Prepared by: Lovelynne Heart Tabunlupa
Representative Email: tovelynneheart@gmail.com

Submitted Documents:
 OA-CSO Application Form
 Data Sheet
 Certificate of Good Standing
 Mayor's Permit & BIR Registration
 Certificate of Registration
 Certificate of Good Standing (GA)
 Omnibus Sworn Statement
 Secretary's Certificate
 Accomplishment Reports
 Supplementary Documents

Status:
 Pending
 Pending
 Accredited
 Denied

Remarks:
 No remarks

Save Changes

Figure 25. Admin Application Status Update

Figure 26 displays the list of accredited users, with details like application date, organization, representative, and actions for viewing applications.

Accreditation Applications

New Applications Accredited Denied

Accredited Applications

Show 6 entries Search

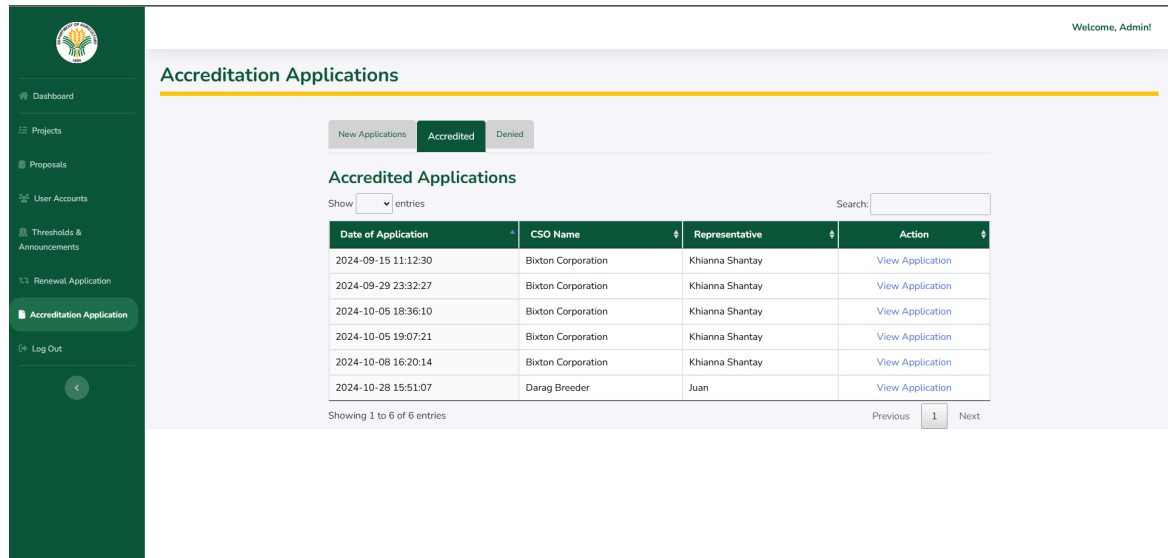
Date of Application	CSO Name	Representative	Action
2024-09-15 11:12:30	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-09-29 23:32:27	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-05 18:36:10	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-05 19:07:21	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-08 16:20:14	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-28 15:51:07	Darag Breeders	Juan Dela Cruz	View Application

Showing 1 to 6 of 6 entries Previous 1 Next

Figure 26. List of Accredited Users

Figure 27 displays a list of approved accreditation application submitted by various CSO users. It includes the

application date, the CSO's name, and the representative's name. In the action column, the admin can view the full application details submitted by each CSO.



The screenshot displays the 'Accreditation Applications' section of a web application. On the left is a dark green sidebar with a logo at the top and a list of menu items: Dashboard, Projects, Proposals, User Accounts, Thresholds & Announcements, Renewal Application, Accreditation Application (highlighted), and Log Out. The main content area has a light blue header with 'Welcome, Admin!' on the right. Below the header, the 'Accreditation Applications' title is followed by three tabs: 'New Applications', 'Accredited' (selected), and 'Denied'. Under the 'Accredited' tab, there's a section titled 'Accredited Applications' with a 'Show' dropdown set to 'entries' and a search bar. A table lists six entries with columns for Date of Application, CSO Name, Representative, and Action. The first five entries are from Bixton Corporation with representative Khianna Shantay, and the last is from Darag Breeder with representative Juan. Each entry has a 'View Application' link. At the bottom, it shows 'Showing 1 to 6 of 6 entries' and pagination controls for 'Previous', '1', and 'Next'.

Date of Application	CSO Name	Representative	Action
2024-09-15 11:12:30	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-09-29 23:32:27	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-05 18:36:10	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-05 19:07:21	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-08 16:20:14	Bixton Corporation	Khianna Shantay	View Application
2024-10-28 15:51:07	Darag Breeder	Juan	View Application

Figure 27. List of Approved Applications for Accreditation

Figure 28 shows the interface for submitting an accomplishment report, where users can upload files and provide details about the report.

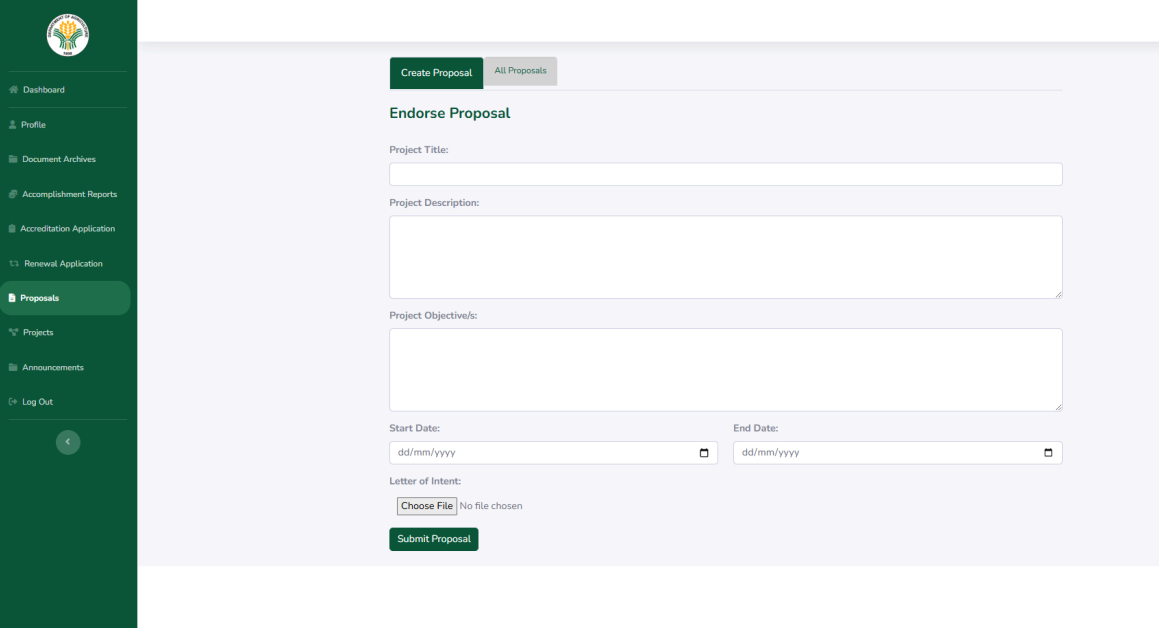
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La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

The screenshot displays the 'Accomplishment Reports' section of the West Visayas State University portal. On the left is a dark green sidebar with navigation links: Dashboard, Profile, Document Archives, Accomplishment Reports (highlighted), Accreditation Application, Renewal Application, Proposals, Projects, Announcements, and Log Out. The main content area is light blue and contains the 'Accomplishment Reports' form. This form includes a 'Choose File' button, a 'No file chosen' status, a link to open a template, and input fields for Solvency, ROI, and Liquidity. A green 'Submit' button is at the bottom of the form. To the right of the form is a 'PDF Viewer' window showing a blank document. Below the form is a 'Financial Reports' table with the following data:

File	Solvency	ROI	Liquidity	Upload Date
pdf test.pdf	0.22	0.29	0.32	2024-11-07 01:28:59

Figure 28. Submission of Accomplishment Report

Figure 29 illustrates the CSO's (Civil Society Organization) interface for endorsing project proposals, including fields for project title, description, and justification.



The screenshot displays a web application interface for endorsing proposals. On the left is a dark green sidebar with a circular logo at the top and a list of navigation items: Dashboard, Profile, Document Archives, Accomplishment Reports, Accreditation Application, Renewal Application, Proposals (highlighted), Projects, Announcements, and Log Out. The main content area has a light gray background. At the top of this area are two tabs: 'Create Proposal' (active) and 'All Proposals'. Below the tabs is the heading 'Endorse Proposal'. The form contains three text input fields: 'Project Title:', 'Project Description:', and 'Project Objective/s:'. Below these are two date pickers labeled 'Start Date:' and 'End Date:', both showing the format 'dd/mm/yyyy'. A 'Letter of Intent:' section includes a 'Choose File' button and the text 'No file chosen'. At the bottom of the form is a green 'Submit Proposal' button.

Figure 29. CSO Endorsing Proposals

Figure 30 shows the "Project for CSO" feature, where users can create and manage project details within a project management interface.

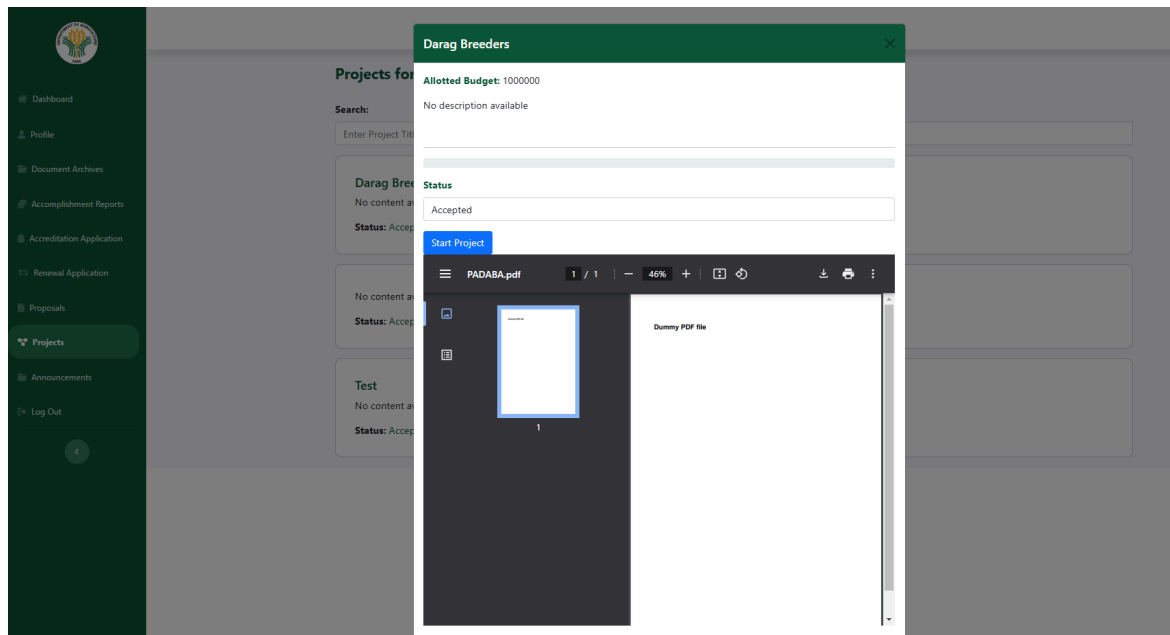


Figure 30. Project for CSO

Figure 31 displays the "Announcements" section, which provides a platform for sharing important updates and information with users.

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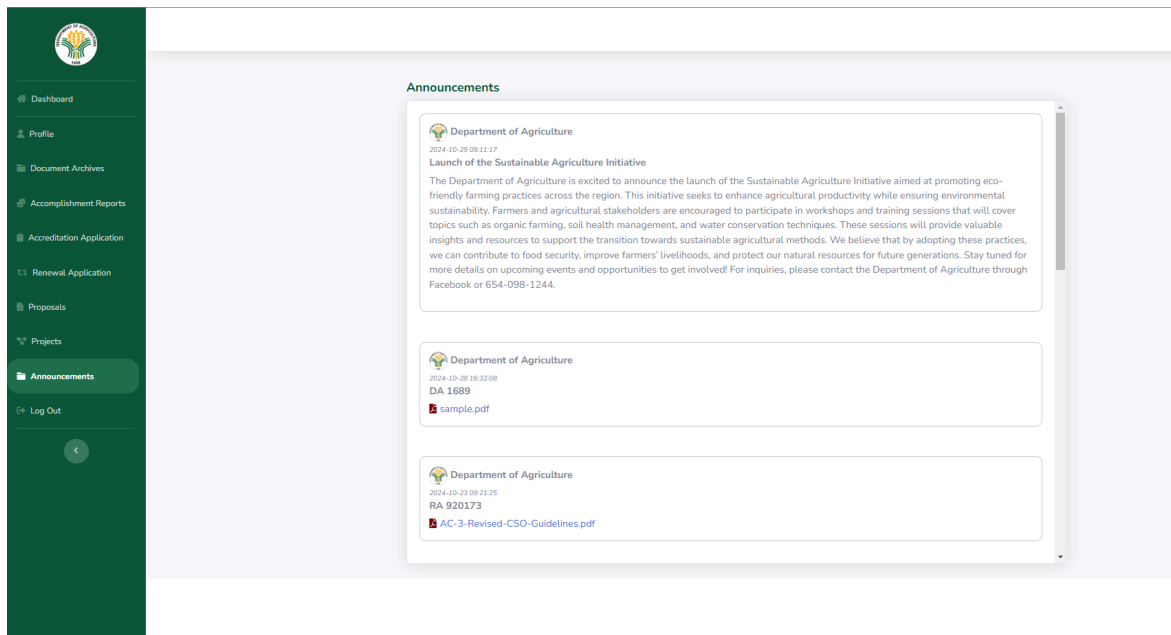


Figure 31. Announcements

Figure 32 shows the "Renewed Application" form, where users can apply for accreditation by filling in various required details.

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Apply for Accreditation

Fill out the following information to proceed with the application. For the CSO Information, make sure that the data is updated and accurate. If not, please update the CSO Information in the Profile tab in the CSO Account.

CSO Office Information

CSO Name* 123 CSO CSO Address* 123

Region* Region VI Province* Iloilo City* Iloilo

Barangay* Barangay Street* a Zip Code* 5000

Email* user@wvsu.edu.ph

Chairperson

Last Name* Dela Cruz First Name* Juan Middle Name* Reyes

Documentary Requirements

Scanned DA-CSO Application Form*

Click to download the DA-CSO Application Form

Choose File No file chosen

Accomplished Data Sheet with Organizational Set-up*

Choose File No file chosen

Certificate of Good Standing from Local Chief Executive*
or Head of a Local Religious Organizations where the program/project will be implemented

Figure 32. Renewal of Application

Figures 33 and 34 display dashboard interfaces for managing and analyzing project and accreditation data. Figure 33 shows the "CSO Status Dashboard," with pie charts indicating the progress of accreditation applications, while Figure 34 illustrates the "Analytical Dashboard," featuring pie charts and bar graphs that provide insights into project distribution, proposals, and various status metrics.

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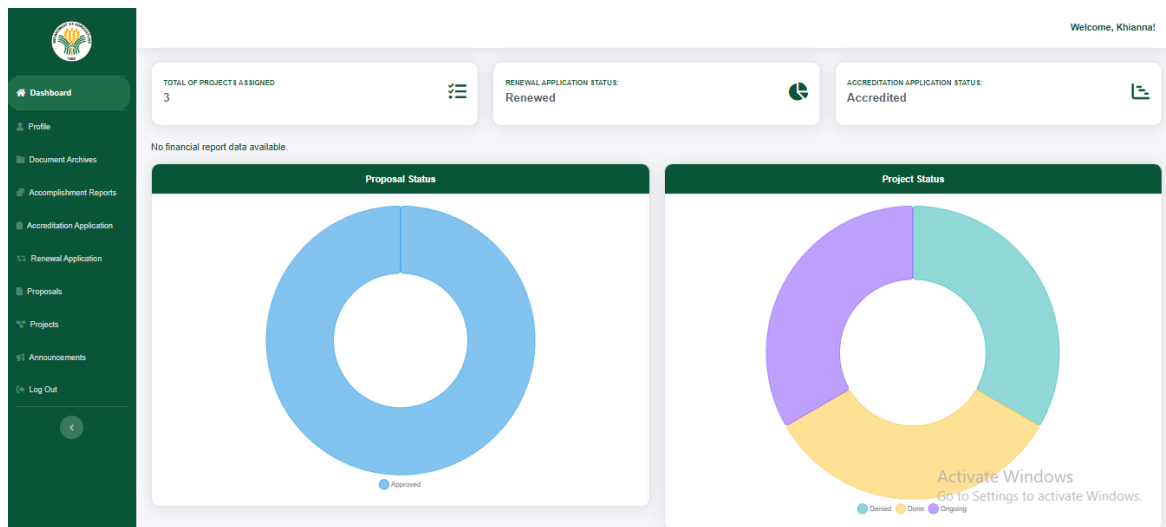


Figure 33. CSO Dashboard

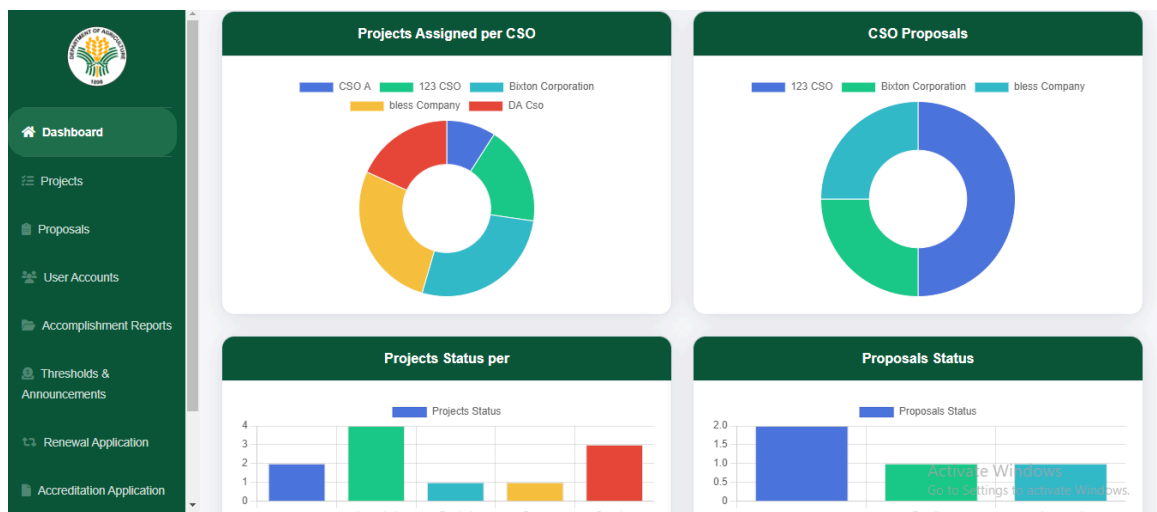


Figure 34. Admin Dashboard

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La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

Figure 35 showcases an admin announcement section for posting notices, while Figure 36 reveals an admin dashboard that highlights top-performing CSOs and includes additional features for managing projects, approvals, user accounts, and other administrative tasks. The dashboard's design suggests a web-based application with a user-friendly interface that utilizes visual elements for data representation.

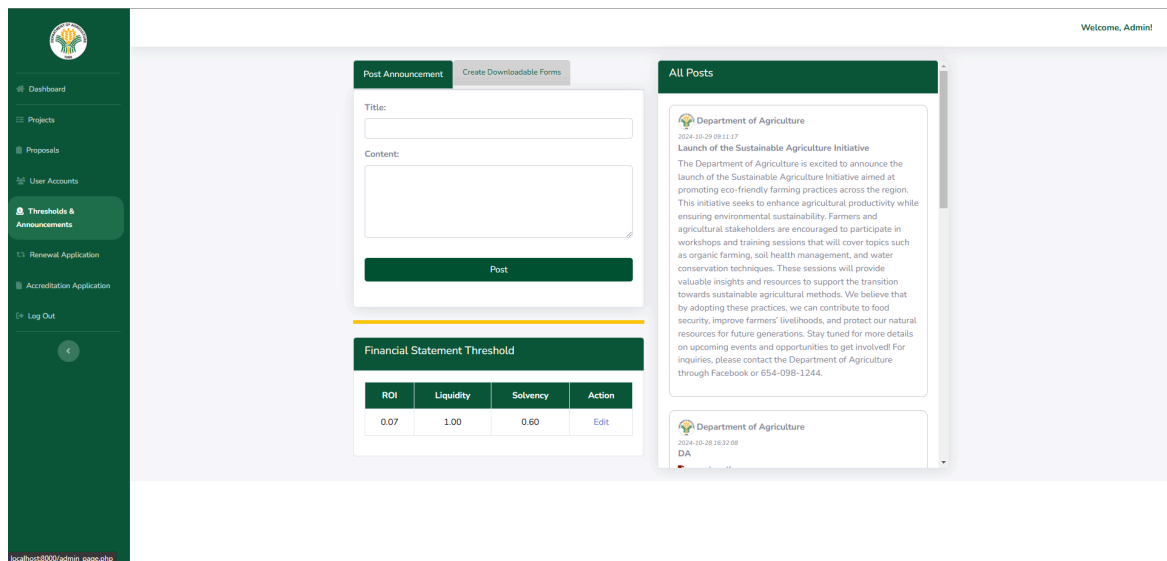


Figure 35. Announcements by Admin

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La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

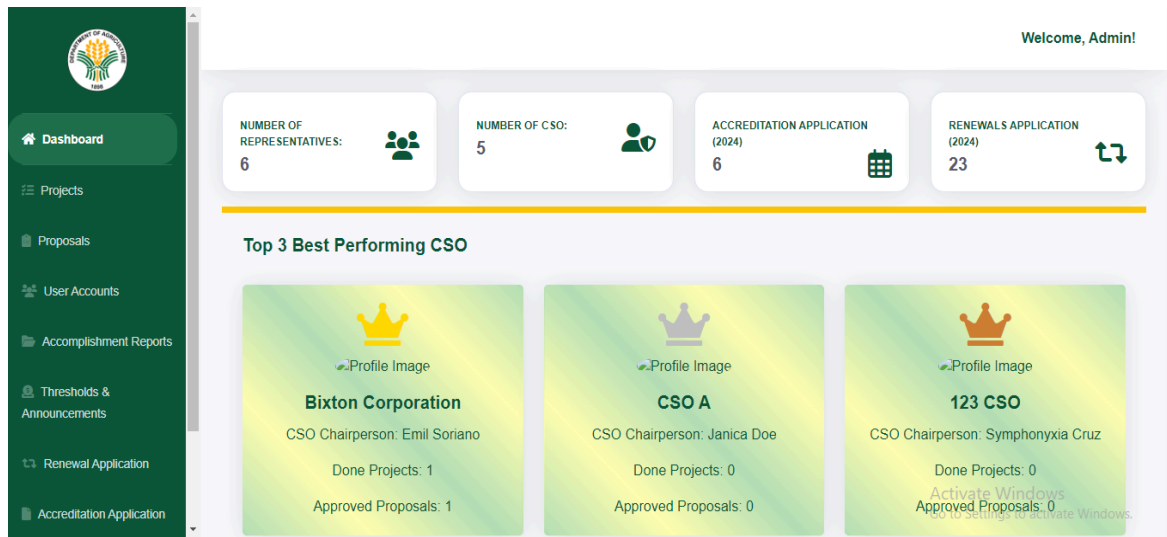


Figure 36. Admin Dashboard (2)

Figure 37 displays an archive section with folders for Revenue, Accreditation, and Accomplishment Reports, suggesting a document management system for organizing and storing important files.

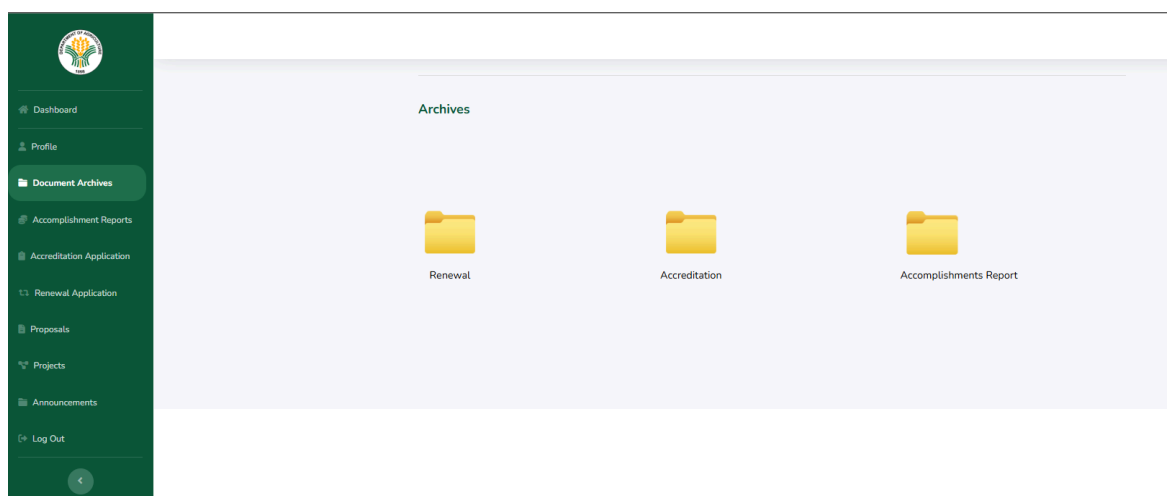


Figure 37. CSO Archive Documents

Results Interpretation and Analysis

*Enhancing Civil Society Organization (CSO) Accreditation and
Performance Evaluation Process through Document Management:
A Web-Based System for the Department of Agriculture Region
6*

The proposed web-based system for the Department of Agriculture (DA) is designed to streamline and optimize its collaboration with Civil Society Organizations (CSOs). By automating key processes such as accreditation, project management, and performance evaluation, the system aims to enhance efficiency, transparency, and accountability, ultimately strengthening the partnership between the DA and CSOs.

To address users' needs, the researchers developed a system that automates the registration and accreditation process, reducing manual intervention and increasing approval times. CSOs can schedule visits and receive real-time feedback from the DA. The platform enables CSOs to submit proposals and receive project assignments directly. The DA can monitor project progress in real-time, facilitating timely interventions and decision-making.

The system securely archives verified documents and provides a centralized platform for the DA to disseminate information and guidelines to CSOs. Real-time communication fosters efficient collaboration. CSOs can submit annual accomplishments and financial reports. The CSO's financial indicator will be established by assessing their ROI, solvency, and liquidity using baseline data. The system then evaluates CSO performance using a weighted scoring methodology based on these variables, which results in a CSO performance ranking.

By automating tasks, improving communication, and providing data-driven insights, the system empowers both the DA and CSOs to work more efficiently and effectively together. This can lead to improved project outcomes, increased transparency, and ultimately, a more sustainable and resilient agricultural sector.

System Evaluation Results

*Enhancing Civil Society Organization (CSO) Accreditation and
Performance Evaluation Process through Document Management:
A Web-Based System for the Department of Agriculture Region
6*

The researchers presented the system to a panel of evaluators from the field of agriculture, specifically from the Department of Agriculture (DA), system developers, and CSOs under the DA. The researchers utilized the ISO/IEC 25010 standard to assess user satisfaction with the system's requirements and its ability to address the research problem.

The evaluation criteria consisted of four sections: functional suitability, usability, security, and maintainability. The researchers used a five-point Likert scale to measure the system's effectiveness and quality. The form comprised twelve questions. The evaluators rated each criterion accordingly, and the results were compiled into area means.

Users' Evaluation

The evaluation results show that for functional suitability, the jurors rated the system's functional completeness, accuracy, timeliness, and consistency as "Excellent," with an area mean of 4.2. For usability, the jurors rated the system's learnability, operability, user interface aesthetics, and accessibility as "Excellent," with an area mean of 4.4. In terms of security, the jurors rated the system's confidentiality, integrity, accountability, and authenticity as "Very Satisfactory," with an area mean of 4.0. Finally, for maintainability, the jurors rated the system's modifiability, testability, and adaptability as "Excellent," with an area mean of 4.3.

Criteria	Area Mean
Functional Suitability	4.2
Usability	4.4
Security	4.0
Maintainability	4.3

Scale. 5.00-4.20 = Excellent; 4.19-3.39 = Very Satisfactory; 3.38-2.58 = Satisfactory; 2.57-1.77 = Fair; 1.76-1.00 = Poor.

Table 1. Evaluation Results of the Proposed System

CHAPTER 5 SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Summary of the Proposed Study Design and Implementation

*Enhancing Civil Society Organization (CSO) Accreditation and
Performance Evaluation Process through Document Management:
A Web-Based System for the Department of Agriculture Region
6*

The objective of this study is to develop a web-based system to streamline the accreditation process for Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) under the Department of Agriculture (DA). The system aims to centralize CSO registration, document verification, project monitoring, and accreditation renewal processes, providing a secure and efficient platform for managing essential records, verifying documents, and tracking the ongoing performance of accredited CSOs.

This system is designed to improve operational efficiency for the DA by giving CSOs an integrated platform to manage compliance and project activities. Since most CSOs operate in provincial areas while the DA Region 6 office is located in the city, the system also reduces the need for

time-consuming travel for in-person accreditation and project monitoring, enhancing accessibility and convenience.

The system features an interactive dashboard for DA administrators, providing real-time metrics such as the total number of accredited and denied CSOs, financial performance indicators, and visual representations of compliance based on DA-defined thresholds. The dashboard also includes data visualizations that track the status of ongoing projects, enabling administrators to efficiently monitor progress and allocate resources.

Additionally, the system collects and processes essential data, such as CSO registration details, accreditation documentation, project performance records, and compliance metrics, and incorporates an annual performance evaluation tool. Using key indicators like return on investment (ROI), liquidity, solvency, and compliance, the evaluation applies a weighted scoring methodology to rank CSOs. This enables the DA to assess CSO performance effectively and make informed decisions on accreditation renewal and funding allocations.

The system also includes a project management component, allowing CSOs to track project progress and submit updates directly through the platform. Together, these features aim to create a transparent, reliable, and efficient accreditation and project monitoring system to support the DA's oversight of CSOs.

Summary of Findings

One of the challenges faced by the Department of Agriculture (DA) and Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) is accreditation, particularly due to the extensive documentation required from CSOs and the verification processes conducted by the DA. This process often includes a thorough background investigation as well as a review of financial statements and accomplishment reports to verify CSO legitimacy. The accreditation workflow is lengthy and complex, further hindered by the need for in-person processes, especially since many CSOs operate in remote provinces, adding significant time and resource constraints for both parties. Currently, the DA handles these processes manually, lacking a streamlined, digital system to manage and archive the substantial volume of documents required for accreditation.

To address these challenges, the researcher developed a system called "CSO Accreditation with Performance Evaluation and Document Management System." This system aims to streamline the accreditation process by integrating document management and performance evaluation functionalities. By digitizing document submission, verification, and archiving,

this solution supports data-driven decision-making, reduces processing time, and offers CSOs more accessible and manageable accreditation processes.

Conclusions

The researchers successfully achieved the objectives set for this study through the development and evaluation of a web-based system aimed at enhancing the Department of Agriculture's (DA) accreditation and performance evaluation process for Civil Society Organizations (CSOs). The following conclusions were drawn from the results of this study:

The system developed allows the Department of Agriculture (DA) to streamline the accreditation process for Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) by centralizing the collection, verification, and archiving of essential documents. This ensures accuracy and accessibility, improving the efficiency of both accreditation and renewal processes. The system further enables real-time monitoring of project progress and performance assessment, providing a comprehensive view of each CSO's contributions toward agricultural development.

A key feature of the system is the integration of a weighted scoring methodology. This approach evaluates CSO performance based on financial and operational metrics,

allowing the DA to rank CSOs objectively. Through this ranking mechanism, high-performing organizations can be identified and prioritized, facilitating a fair, data-driven decision-making process. This scoring system enhances transparency and consistency, incentivizing CSOs to maintain high standards.

Moreover, user evaluation played an essential role in refining the system's functionality, usability, and overall quality. Employing ISO/IEC 25010 standards, the system was evaluated across various dimensions, such as functional suitability, usability, and security. Feedback from CSOs and DA representatives highlighted high levels of user satisfaction, which was reflected in effectiveness, efficiency, and satisfaction scores. This evaluation confirmed the system's alignment with user needs while also pointing to areas for continuous improvement.

In summary, this system provides an efficient, data-driven solution that enhances the transparency, accountability, and operational efficiency of DA-CSO collaborations. The implementation of this system is expected to foster a more data-informed approach within the

DA, contributing to more effective agricultural initiatives and supporting the socioeconomic development of rural communities.

Recommendations

Based on the results and conclusions drawn from this study, the following recommendations are proposed to enhance and expand the capabilities of the web-based accreditation and performance evaluation system for Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) under the Department of Agriculture (DA) Region 6:

1. Allow CSO president or chairperson accounts to perform the same actions as representatives, enabling them to submit documents and apply for accreditation and renewals directly.
2. Add a direct messaging feature to improve communication between the DA and CSOs, allowing for quick updates and support within the system.
3. Implement advanced document verification tools like OCR and digital signatures to ensure document accuracy and authenticity.
4. Broaden performance metrics for ranking CSOs, including more detailed financial and project outcome indicators.
5. Add geolocation to project monitoring to verify project sites and track progress remotely.

6. Include a feedback option for CSOs to share their experiences with the accreditation process, helping the DA make improvements.

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Appendices

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La Paz, Iloilo City, Philippines

Appendix A List of Documentary Requirements for
Accreditation

1. Accomplished Data Sheet with Organizational Set-Up;
2. Certification of Good Standing from Local Chief
Executive or Head of Agency of a local religious
organization where the program/ project will be
implemented;
- 3.

Appendix B System Evaluation Form



West Visayas State University
Primarily with Normal Schools
COLLEGE OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS
TECHNOLOGY
Luna St., La Paz, Iloilo City 5000
Iloilo, Philippines
** Faxline: (033) 330-0870 to 75 loc. 1822 ** Telefax No.: (033) 330-0870
** Website: www.wvsu.edu.ph ** Email Address: info@wvsu.edu.ph



**Enhancing CSO Accreditation and Performance Evaluation Process through
Document Management: A Web-Based System for the Department of
Agriculture in Region 6**

Date:

Name:

Age:

Type of Respondent:

Organization and Position:

Signature:

Directions:

Please check the appropriate box for each question based on the scale provided.

Scale	Description	
5	Excellent: This indicates the highest level of satisfaction, agreement, or positive sentiment. It suggests that the respondent is highly pleased or strongly agrees with the statement.	
4	Very Satisfactory: This rating shows a strong level of satisfaction or agreement. It implies that the respondent is generally pleased or strongly agrees with the statement, but may have some minor reservations.	
3	Satisfactory: This rating indicates a neutral or moderate level of satisfaction or agreement. It suggests that the respondent is neither strongly positive nor negative about the statement.	
2	Fair: This rating suggests a level of dissatisfaction or disagreement. It implies that the respondent is somewhat displeased or disagrees with the statement, but not strongly.	
1	Poor: This rating indicates the lowest level of satisfaction, agreement, or positive sentiment. It suggests that the respondent is highly dissatisfied or strongly disagrees with the statement.	

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	5 (Excellent)	4 (Very Satisfactory)	3 (Satisfactory)	2 (Fair)	1 (Poor)
Functionality					
1. Does the system provide the necessary functions to meet the user's needs and expectations?					
2. Are the functions of the system accurate and complete?					
3. Does the system respond to user input and process data in a timely manner?					
4. Does the system utilize system resources efficiently?					
5. Does the system consistently perform its intended functions without failures?					
Usability					
6. Is the system easy to learn and use?					
7. Is the user interface intuitive and clear?					



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Security					
8. Does the system protect sensitive information from unauthorized access, use, disclosure, disruption, modification, or destruction?					
9. Does the system implement strong access controls to limit access to authorized users only?					
Maintainability (For admin and IT Professionals only)					
10. Is the system easy to modify and adapt to changing requirements?					
11. Is the system well-documented to facilitate maintenance and troubleshooting?					
12. Is the system's source code well-structured, commented, and easy to understand?					
Additional Remarks:					



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Appendix C. Letter to Evaluators



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Department of Agriculture
Hamungaya, Jaro, Iloilo City, 5000

Dear Ma'am/Sir,

We hope this letter finds you well. We are student researchers from West Visayas State University College of Information Communication Technology, currently working on our thesis project titled "Enhancing CSO Accreditation and Performance Evaluation Process through Document Management: A Web-Based System for the Department of Agriculture in Region 6." As part of our research, we have developed a system aimed at enhancing CSO accreditation and project monitoring, which we believe could significantly contribute to the field.

I am writing to request your assistance as a system evaluator. Your expertise with the Department of Agriculture's Regional Technical Secretariat, particularly in managing CSO applications and system administration, would be invaluable in assessing the system's functionality and usability from an administrative perspective. Your feedback will be instrumental in identifying areas for improvement and ensuring that the system meets the needs of its intended users.

The evaluation process will involve testing the system and providing feedback on your experience using it. We will gladly provide you with access to the system and any necessary documentation to facilitate your evaluation.

Please let us know if you would be willing to participate in this evaluation process. We are looking forward to your insights and feedback, which will be critical for the success of our project.

Thank you for considering my request. We are hopeful to hear from you soon

Sincerely,



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Noted by:

DR. MA. BETH S. CONCEPCION
Research Group Adviser

